

Global Clothing & Personal Styling Research

Foundations for an inclusive, culturally aware AI wardrobe assistant

Research conducted: 28 September 2026 (web research; English-language sources only)

Prepared as: a single-author synthesis written from the perspective of the interdisciplinary team described in the brief (historian, stylist, textile expert, colour specialist, anthropologist, fit specialist, consumer researcher, product researcher, data architect).

How to read this document. Every substantive claim carries an **evidence tier** (E1-E4) and a **claim type** tag. Sources are listed in the Source Register (Section A.4) with IDs such as [S6]. Where I could not find or verify a source, the text says so instead of filling the gap. Nothing here is complete or universally applicable.

Important honesty note. This pass retrieved and read about 25 targeted web searches. It did **not** systematically review the academic literature, museum catalogues or industry databases the brief asks for. Sections marked **E3** synthesise widely shared textile-science and styling practice that I did not individually verify against a primary source in this session. Treat them as well-informed hypotheses to be verified (see Section J and the roadmap).

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A. Executive summary

A.1 Scope, method and coverage

What was done. Around 25 web searches (28 Sep 2026) retrieved and read excerpts from scholarly monographs, journal abstracts, museum and university pages, health-institution guidance, NGO/industry reports and a small number of popular or commercial pages. The rest of the document (rulebook, taxonomies, outfits, decision tree, data model, evaluation plan) is a **design synthesis** intended to be verified and extended, not a finished evidence review.

Region / topic	What was actually retrieved in this pass	Not covered / thin
Southern Africa (Zambia)	Hansen's <i>Salaula</i> (secondhand clothing, Zambia) [S1]; chitenge context from popular sources [S24-S26]	Contemporary Lusaka office/university norms; shweshwe, Zambian ceremonial dress (no source retrieved)
West / East Africa	Dutch wax print history [S21-S23]; kente [S27-S29]; kitenge naming [S25]	Agbada, boubou, gele, dashiki, Ethiopian/Eritrean dress, North Africa (no sources retrieved)
Middle East / Muslim-majority contexts	Bedouin robe heat study [S6-S7]; modest-fashion scholarship covering Iran, Indonesia, Turkey, UK, US [S18-S20]	Gulf workplace dress codes, thobe/abaya norms, Levant, Maghreb
South Asia	Sari: RISD Museum text [S30]; Boulanger reprint [S31]; a weak Wikipedia count of drapes [S32]	Men's dress (kurta, sherwani), Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, regional workwear
East Asia	Hanbok history/rental study abstract [S33-S34]	Kimono (only a passing mention), Chinese dress, Japanese street-style communities
Latin America	Mexican huipil and the 2022 heritage-protection law and disputes [S35-S36]	Andean, Brazilian, Caribbean, Southern Cone practices
Europe / North America	Textile waste and wear-frequency figures [S10-S11]; enclothed-cognition experiments [S2-S4]; sizing [S38-S39]	Workplace dress-code research, regional European customs, Indigenous North American dress
Not covered at all	Central Asia, Russia, Pacific Islands, South-East Asia beyond Indonesia (as a modest-fashion site), Australia/NZ	-

A.2 Evidence tiers and claim-type tags used throughout

Tag	Meaning
E1	Retrieved and read in this session: peer-reviewed article/abstract, scholarly monograph, museum/curatorial or university text.
E2	Retrieved: secondary or institutional sources (patient-education pages, news features, NGO or industry reports, reviews, encyclopaedia entries).
E3	Design synthesis of widely shared textile-science, tailoring and styling practice. Not individually verified here; needs sourcing before being presented to users as fact.
E4	Commercial content, trend, or individual-stylist opinion; useful as hypotheses only.
[P] / [C] / [Pref] / [T] / [\$] / [Op] / [W]	Claim type: widely supported Principle / Cultural or regional convention / personal Preference / temporary Trend / \$ commercial advice / individual stylist Opinion / Weak or lacking evidence.

A.3 Ten headline findings for the product

- **1. Clothing 'rules' split into four different kinds of knowledge** - physical facts (fabric, heat, UV, mobility), local conventions (what a workplace or ceremony expects), personal taste, and trends. A recommender that merges them will give confident but wrong advice. Every rule in the knowledge base should be tagged with its type and its region/context.
- **2. Physical, testable claims are the strongest.** Examples: fabric moisture behaviour [S12-S13], sun protection depends on weave, colour, weight, stretch and wetness [S8-S9], loose fit matters more than colour for desert heat load in the classic Bedouin study [S6] (with caveats). These can power weather/climate logic.
- **3. Skin-tone 'season' colour rules are weakly supported.** The one small study retrieved found only 40% agreement between observers and analysts (35 subjects) [S5]. The rest of the material is commercial [S41]. Colour advice should be optional, preference-led, and never restrictive.
- **4. 'Clothes change how you perform' is real but modest and contested.** The famous lab-coat experiment [S2] had a failed preregistered replication attempt [S3]; a later evidence review raised concerns about early studies but found support for post-2015 studies [S4]. Do not tell users a garment will make them smarter or more professional.

- **5. Formality is contextual.** Meaning depends on place, sector and community; the assistant must ask for or infer the dress-code context and offer 'how to check' options rather than assume a universal ladder.
- **6. Many garments are cultural, religious or legally/ethically protected in some contexts.** Examples: kente's royal/ceremonial history [S27-S28]; huipil designs and Mexico's 2022 heritage law and disputes [S35-S36]; wax-print's layered Indonesian-Dutch-African history [S21-S23]. The assistant should describe context, avoid 'costume' framing, and never suggest sacred or community-owned items to outsiders as generic style.
- **7. Second-hand clothing is a mainstream wardrobe strategy in many places, not a stigma.** Hansen shows secondhand ('salaula') clothes in Zambia are actively selected, altered and made local [S1]. Budget logic must treat markets and thrift as first-class.
- **8. Sizing labels are unreliable.** There is no global standard and labels vary by brand [S38-S39]; the data model must store measurements and personal fit notes rather than trusting size labels.
- **9. Inclusion needs structured accommodations.** Disability-focused focus-group research names mechanical, cultural and sensory barriers [S16]; adaptive-clothing features (magnetic closures, elastic waists, larger pulls) are documented by a health charity [S17]. Comfort, mobility and modesty must be first-class inputs, not afterthoughts.
- **10. Sustainability and reuse align with the user goal 'use what I own'.** Industry analysis reports falling garment utilisation and low recycling [S10-S11]; cost-per-wear and re-styling are useful framings, but avoid guilt or moralising.

A.4 Source register

Strength ratings are my judgement of how far each source supports the specific claim it is used for, not of the source's overall quality. 'Date' is the publication/update date if visible in the retrieved excerpt, otherwise 'n/s' (not shown). All URLs were retrieved 28 Sep 2026.

ID	Source (type)	Date	Region / population	Strength; limitations
S1	Hansen, K.T. <i>Salaula: The World of Secondhand Clothing and Zambia</i> , Univ. of Chicago Press. press.uchicago.edu/ucp/books/book/chicago/S/bo3644128.html (scholarly monograph; prizes listed by nationalhumanitiescenter.org)	2000	Zambia; supply chain from N. America/W. Europe	E1, strong for late-1990s Zambia. Dated; one academic review criticises photo representation and depth of engagement with Zambian identities (academia.edu review page). Do not extrapolate to today.
S2	Adam & Galinsky, 'Enclothed cognition', <i>J. Experimental Social Psychology</i> 48(4):918-925. researchportal.bath.ac.uk/en/publications/enclothed-cognition/ (journal article)	2012	Lab experiments, student samples	E1, weak-moderate. Small experiments; see S3-S4.
S3	Burns et al., 'An Old Task in New Clothes: A Preregistered Direct Replication...' <i>JESP</i> . scholarsmine.mst.edu/psysci_facwork/178 (journal article)	n/s (c. 2019)	Lab, US university	E1. Found that an effect, if present, is too small to detect under the original design.
S4	Journal article on evidential value of enclothed-cognition studies. journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/01461672231182478 (abstract only read)	c. 2023	Published lab studies	E1, moderate. Only abstract seen: concerns about early studies; evidential value for post-2015 studies.
S5	Study of personal colour for clothes (repository record). cuir.car.chula.ac.th/handle/123456789/78676	n/s	35 subjects; region not stated in excerpt	E1, weak. Tiny sample; 40% observer-analyst agreement; skin-tone chart could not group subjects. Full text not read.
S6	Shkolnik et al., 'Why do Bedouins wear black robes in hot deserts?', <i>Nature</i> 283:373-375. doi.org/10.1038/283373a0	24 Jan 1980	Sinai Bedouin robes	E1, weak-moderate. Secondary source [S7] reports a single volunteer, ~30 min sessions, disputed at the time.
S7	ScienceABC feature on dark hoodies in heat. scienceabc.com/eyeopeners/why-construction-workers-wear-dark-hoodies-in-extreme-heat (popular science)	2026	General	E2. Used only for the study-design caveats on [S6]; its 2026 studies were not read in full.
S8	UCSF Health, 'Protective Clothing for Skin Cancer Prevention'. ucsfhealth.org/education/protective-clothing-for-skin-cancer-prevention (patient education)	n/s	US clinical audience	E2, good for principles (weave, colour, weight, stretch, wetness); does not cite primary studies in the excerpt.
S9	Univ. of Arizona Cancer Center, 'Sun protective clothing'. cancercenter.arizona.edu/research/skin-cancer-institute/skin-cancer-prevention/sun-protective-clothing	n/s	US clinical audience	E2. UPF standardised in Australia in 1996; wet fabric weakens protection; wide-brim hats.
S10	Ellen MacArthur Foundation, <i>A New Textiles Economy</i> (summary of findings). sesync.org/sites/default/files/2023-02/MacArthur%20Foundation%20-%20Abbreviated%20Reading.pdf	Nov 2017	Global	E2, moderate. NGO modelling; figures are its estimates and 9 years old.

ID	Source (type)	Date	Region / population	Strength; limitations
S11	EU Circular Economy Stakeholder Platform slides citing EEA (2020) and EMF (2017). circulareconomy.europa.eu/platform/sites/default/files/2023-02/Gwen%20Cunningham%20-%20EUCT%208%20Feb%202023.pdf	8 Feb 2023	EU	E2. Secondary presentation; use only for order-of-magnitude context.
S12	MDPI <i>Fibers</i> 11(5):47 (dynamic moisture-regain test). doi.org/10.3390/fib11050047	n/s	Lab fabrics	E1, moderate. Values at 30 min, not equilibrium; specific fabrics only.
S13	DTIC report ADA276420 on fibre/fabric properties and drying time. apps.dtic.mil/sti/pdfs/ADA276420.pdf	n/s (1990s)	Lab fabrics	E1, moderate. Excerpt only; says drying time depends mainly on initial water held (thickness).
S14	Maruf, 'Cotton Clothing Comfort Compare to Polyester', <i>Int. J. Textile Eng. & Processes</i> 3(2). engineering-shirpur.nmims.edu/docs/cotton-clothing-comfort-compare-to-polyester.pdf	Apr 2017	Bangladesh/tropical claim	E2, weak. Low-tier article; useful mainly for regain figures and its caution that comfort is not predicted by a single test.
S15	Article on sportswear fabric thermal/moisture comfort. or.nispr.res.in/index.php/IJFTR/article/download/7646/2369/26999	n/s	Lab knit fabrics	E1, moderate. 100% polyester knits outperformed cotton for wicking in that study.
S16	Kabel, McBee-Black & Dimka, 'Apparel-Related Participation Barriers', <i>Disability and Rehabilitation</i> (via Univ. of Missouri release). munewsarchives.missouri.edu/news-releases/2016/0614-apparel-causes-additional-barriers-for-people-living-with-disabilities	Jun 2016	US focus groups	E1/E2, moderate (qualitative, small). Three barrier categories.
S17	Parkinson's Australia, 'Adaptive clothing'. parkinsons.org.au/information-hub/adaptive-clothing/	n/s	Australia; Parkinson's community	E2. Practical features list; not a trial.
S18	Bucar, E. <i>Pious Fashion: How Muslim Women Dress</i> , Harvard UP (via Publishers Weekly summary). publishersweekly.com/9780674976160	2017	Iran, Indonesia, Turkey fieldwork	E1, strong (I read summaries, not the book).
S19	Open University OpenLearn, 'Hijab and fashion' (Tarlo). open.edu/openlearn/history-the-arts/veiling/content-section-3.2	n/s	UK/global	E1/E2. Course text summarising ethnographic work.
S20	Bullock review of <i>Modest Fashion</i> collection, <i>Am. J. Islam & Society</i> . doaj.org/article/3b0846e5f76743689bdb2aa912ccf665	Jul 2015	Muslim, Jewish, Christian, secular modest dress	E1. Book review (not the book).
S21	SMBA / Raw Material Company, 'Hollandaise: a journey into an iconic fabric' (e-flux). e-flux.com/announcements/32866/hollandaise-a-journey-into-an-iconic-fabric/	n/s	West Africa, Netherlands, Java	E1/E2 (curatorial text, has a stated critical perspective).
S22	Hemmings, J. 'Vlisco Wax Resist Fabrics'. jessicahemmings.com/vlisco-wax-resist-fabrics	n/s	West/Central Africa	E1/E2 (scholar's essay).
S23	'Wax print: Africa's pride or colonial legacy?' (feature citing A. Grosfilley, <i>African Wax Print Textiles</i>). myjoyonline.com/wax-print-africas-pride-or-colonial-legacy/	n/s	West Africa/Netherlands	E2. Says the soldiers-brought-cloth origin story cannot be proven.
S24	Wilderness Destinations, 'Unwrapping the cultural history of the chitenge'. wildernessdestinations.com/journal/cultures-and-communities/unwrapping-the-cultural-history-of-the-chitenge	2 Oct 2014	Southern/Central Africa	E2, weak (travel-company essay).
S25	Wikipedia, 'Kitenge'. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kitenge	n/s	East/Central/West Africa	E2, weak. Tagged as needing citations; conflicts with S24 on Malawian men (see D.1).
S26	Pocket Cultures blog, 'Chitenge: Zambian fashion essential'. pocketcultures.com/2010/05/19/chitenge-zambian-fashion-essential/	19 May 2010	Zambia (rural, expatriate view)	E2, weak. Personal blog; 2010.
S27	Minneapolis Institute of Art, 'Asante Kente Cloth' (teaching resource). new.artsmia.org/programs/teachers-and-students/teaching-the-arts/artwork-in-focus/asante-kente-cloth	n/s	Asante, Ghana	E1. Museum education text.
S28	Micots, C., Smarthistory essay on Asante kente (reprint). brewminate.com/west-african-ashanti-kente-cloth-art/	17 Jul 2017	Asante, Ghana	E1/E2. Scholar's essay via a reprint site.
S29	Newtown Bee archive item on 'Wrapped in Pride' (Smithsonian NMAfA) exhibition. newtownbee.com/?p=98414	10 Sep 1999	Ghana/US	E2. Local news reprint of exhibition release.
S30	RISD Museum sari exhibition text. risdmuseum.org/sites/default/files/museumplus/314042.pdf	n/s	India	E1. Museum exhibition text.
S31	Boulanger, C., 'Fabric Begets Fashion' (<i>Hinduism Today</i> , June 1998 reprint). himalayanacademy.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/1998-june-insight-sari-draping.pdf	1998	India	E2. Popular reprint; useful for the point that drape traditions are under-documented.

ID	Source (type)	Date	Region / population	Strength; limitations
S32	Wikipedia, 'Sari' (drape counts). Www.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sari	n/s	India	E2, weak. Counts differ (80+ vs 108); do not quote a single number.
S33	Son, J. abstract, <i>J. Korean Traditional Costume</i> . biblio.navarchivo.com/eu/bibcite/reference/4849	n/s	Korea	E1 (abstract only).
S34	Wikipedia, 'Hanbok'. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hanbok	n/s	Korea	E2, weak. Used for Hanbok Day (1996).
S35	Wikipedia, 'Federal Law for the Protection of Cultural Heritage of Indigenous and Afro-Mexican Peoples and Communities' (cites WIPO Lex and Center for Art Law)	n/s	Mexico	E2. Law published 17 Jan 2022 per its citation; I did not read the statute.
S36	Mexico News Daily on Oaxaca artisans' accusations against US brands. mexiconewsdaily.com/?p=437435	2025 (page date)	Oaxaca, Mexico	E2. Reports allegations, not adjudicated findings.
S37	Weil, A. 'Sun Protective Clothing?' (relaying Skin Cancer Foundation guidance). drweil.com/?p=128262	10 Aug 2017	US consumers	E2, weak-moderate. Secondary relay; says tight weaves (e.g. denim, wool) protect well and dark/bright colours absorb more UV than white/pastels.
S38	Sizebay, 'Why clothing sizes are inconsistent across brands'. sizebay.com/en/blog/why-clothing-sizes-are-inconsistent-across-brands/	Oct 2024	Mainly US/global retail	E4, weak (vendor blog).
S39	Fashion Law Journal / Omni Calculator sizing explainers. fashionlawjournal.com/why-you-are-a-different-size-in-different-fashion-brand-store/	2026	US-centric	E4, weak. Secondary; historical claims (e.g. 1939 USDA survey) not verified.
S40	Datacolor, 'Metamerism' explainer. datacolor.com/?p=177948; Wikipedia 'Metamerism (color)'	n/s	Industry	E2. Industry education; well-established colour-science concept.
S41	Commercial colour-analysis provider pages (e.g. sterlingstyleacademy.com; vaia.com study aid)	2025-26	Mostly US/EU consumer market	E4. Marketing claims; no evidence offered in the excerpts.
S42	asiantextilestudies.com, 'Dutch Wax'. asiantextilestudies.com/wax.html	n/s	West/East Africa	E2. Naming overlaps (ankara, pagne, kitenge); typical purchase of 6 yards.
S43	Koreascience article (Shim Hwa-jin) on everyday vs traditional hanbok. koreascience.kr/article/JAKO200131559975950.pdf	2001 (per identifier)	Korea	E1 (snippet only): everyday-hanbok interest expanded from the 1990s.
S44	Guadalajara Reporter, 'Keeping Mexico's huipil tradition alive'. theguadalajarareporter.net/index.php/featured/64351-keeping-mexico-s-huipil-tradition-alive	n/s	Mexico	E2. Says huipil is >1,000 years old and Mexico set a National Huipil Day in 2022.

Claims labelled E3 have no S-number because they were not verified in this session.

B. Clothing knowledge framework

Status of this section: E3 unless a source ID is shown. The taxonomies below are a structured design synthesis of common practice for building the product's knowledge base. Entries with cultural variation are examples, not complete or authoritative descriptions of any culture.

B.1 Plain-language glossary

Term	Simple meaning	Term	Simple meaning
Hue	The 'name' of a colour family (red, blue, green).	Value	How light or dark a colour is.
Saturation / chroma	How pure or vivid vs. muted/greyed a colour is.	Contrast	The difference in value/colour between two items (or between clothes and a person's own colouring).
Colour temperature	Whether a colour reads warmer (toward red/yellow) or cooler (toward blue/green).	Undertone	A term stylists use for the subtle warm/cool/neutral cast of skin. Contested as a rule-maker; see B.4.
Silhouette	The overall outline the clothes make on the body.	Drape	How a fabric hangs and moves (fluid vs. stiff).
Hand	How a fabric feels to touch (soft, crisp, rough).	Break (trousers)	The fold where the hem meets the shoe; 'no break' = hem just touches the shoe.
Rise	Distance from crotch seam to waistband (low, mid, high).	Inseam	Inner leg length from crotch to hem.
Ease	Extra room built into a garment beyond body measurements.	Tailored	Cut or altered to follow the body's shape closely without being tight.
Relaxed / oversized	Relaxed = more ease than standard; oversized = deliberately much larger, often with dropped shoulders.	Layering	Wearing more than one garment so each can be added or removed for comfort/weather.
Moisture regain	How much water vapour a fibre takes up from air (as % of dry weight) [S12].	Wicking	Movement of liquid sweat along/through fabric to spread and evaporate.
UPF	Ultraviolet Protection Factor: how much UV a fabric lets through to skin [S8-S9].	Capsule wardrobe	A small set of pieces chosen to combine into many outfits.
Cost per wear	Price of an item divided by the number of times it is worn.	Dress code	Written or unwritten expectation of what to wear at a workplace/event.

B.2 Occasion and context taxonomy (24 contexts)

For each context: practical purpose and common expectations; commonly suitable garments; garments that may be unsuitable and why; how the expectation varies; how to dial formality up/down; what to do when unsure. **All rows are conventions [C] with E3 evidence; none is universal.** 'Unsuitable' means 'may clash with local expectations or the activity', never 'wrong to wear as a person'.

Context	Purpose & common expectations	Commonly suitable	May be unsuitable (why)	Variation, formality dial, and if unsure
1 Office / professional	Comfort for sitting/meeting; signals fit with workplace norms. Range from uniform to casual.	Trousers/skirt/dress, shirt/blouse/knit, blazer or cardigan, closed or neat shoes; local formal dress where customary.	Beachwear, very worn/torn items, strong-scent-holding fabrics in hot offices (comfort), garments restricting safety gear.	Sector, city, and company differ widely. Up: add blazer/structured shoes. Down: knit, chinos, clean sneakers. Unsure: ask HR, check staff photos, dress one notch above the most casual observed.
2 Job interview	Comfort and confidence; matching the employer's culture; avoiding distraction.	Cleanest, best-fitting version of the sector's normal smart wear; comfortable shoes for waiting/walking.	Untested new shoes (blisters), items needing constant adjustment, heavy scents.	Sector matters (finance vs. creative vs. trades). Unsure: ask recruiter 'what do staff typically wear?' and pick one notch above. Do not read character into clothing [S2-S4 show effects are modest].
3 Business meetings	Represent an organisation; adapt to client/host culture.	Smart separates or suits; local business dress (e.g. national or ceremonial formal wear where customary).	Overly casual sportswear; items that offend host religious norms.	Hosting culture leads. Up: jacket/tie/formal local dress. Down: remove tie, knit instead of jacket. Unsure: ask host or mirror the most senior attendee's typical dress.
4 School / university	Comfort for long days, movement, weather; school uniform rules where they exist.	Layers, comfortable trousers/skirts, practical bags, closed or supportive shoes.	Items violating a uniform policy; footwear unsafe for labs/workshops.	Uniform and lab-safety rules override style. Presentations: up one notch. Unsure: read the student code of conduct.

Context	Purpose & common expectations	Commonly suitable	May be unsuitable (why)	Variation, formality dial, and if unsure
5 Dates	Comfort in a specific setting; feeling like yourself.	Clean, comfortable outfit matched to venue (café, restaurant, walk); one 'attention' piece if wanted.	Anything that restricts sitting/walking; untested shoes.	Venue and personal comfort lead. Up: add jacket/statement piece. Down: simple knit + jeans. Unsure: ask the plan/venue, choose comfort.
6 Weddings	Honour hosts; often long day; rules from culture/religion.	Formal or semi-formal wear as invited; local ceremonial dress; smart layers.	Matching the couple's white/colour themes if reserved; head-to-toe black/white where locally significant; items covering religious expectations missed.	Highly culture-specific. Read the invitation; ask a family member. Some communities specify aso-ebi-style colour cloth or fixed palettes [C, E3]. Unsure: ask the host.
7 Funerals / memorials	Respect for the bereaved; family/community customs.	Subdued, modest, clean clothes; local mourning dress; head covering where customary.	Bright party wear, strong logos, very revealing items where unlike local norm.	Colour meanings vary (black common in many Western/Southern African contexts; white in some South Asian and East Asian ones) [E3, verify locally]. Unsure: ask a relative or elder.
8 Religious events	Respect for worship space; modesty rules.	Modest, clean garments; head/shoulder/knee coverings where required; shoe-removal-friendly footwear.	Sleeveless/short items where covering expected; leather where prohibited in some sacred spaces.	Rules differ by faith, community and building. Ask a member or the place of worship. Do not assume uniform rules within a faith [S18-S20].
9 Cultural ceremonies	Participate respectfully; some garments are ceremonial or community-owned.	Ceremonial/traditional dress as guests are invited or advised ; otherwise smart neutral wear.	Outsiders wearing sacred, royal or clan-restricted items; costume-style 'versions'.	See Section D. Ask the host what guests wear; borrow or buy from makers, not copies [S27-S28, S35-S36].
10 Parties / nightlife	Movement, heat in crowds, venue codes, safe travel home.	Breathable layers, comfortable shoes, dark or patterned fabrics that hide spills, expressive pieces.	Very restrictive shoes/clothes; items requiring constant adjusting.	Venue door policy can matter. Up: statement piece. Down: simple top + trousers. Unsure: check the venue/event page.
11 Family events	Comfort across ages; often food/child activity.	Neat casual or smart casual; washable fabrics; local festive dress at holidays.	Delicate fabrics near food/children; highly restrictive shoes.	Family customs vary; ask an elder/organiser.
12 Travel	Comfort for long sitting, layers, security checks, arrival weather, local norms.	Layers, quick-dry or wrinkle-resistant fabrics, slip-on/secure shoes, a scarf/wrap.	New shoes, tight waistbands, single-use items that cannot be washed.	Research destination norms (religious sites, coastal vs. city). Packing model in B.10.
13 Outdoor activities	Protect from sun, wind, rain, insects, terrain.	Long sleeves in sun (UPF, tight weave, wide-brim hat) [S8-S9]; layers; sturdy footwear.	Cotton-only in cold/wet (stays damp - E3); open shoes on rough terrain.	Follow local safety guidance for the activity (mountains, wildlife); do not rely on style advice for safety.
14 Running / exercise	Free movement, sweat management, chafe avoidance, visibility.	Technical or blended knit tops, shorts/leggings, supportive footwear [S15].	Heavy seams, unfitted footwear, restrictive religious-modesty solutions without breathable fabrics.	Modest sports options exist (long sleeves, sports hijab, leggings under shorts) [S19]. For night running use local road-safety guidance.
15 Gym / sports	Mobility, sweat, sport-specific safety and rules.	Breathable tops, stretch bottoms, appropriate shoes; club kit.	Loose jewellery/cords that catch; jeans for lifting/climbing.	Club and league rules lead. Unsure: ask the coach.
16 Formal events	Occasion of state, awards, black-tie/traditional formal.	Tailored suits/formal dress, evening wear, national formal attire.	Ill-fitting rented items; casual footwear.	Read invitation wording ('black tie', 'lounge suit', 'traditional attire') and follow host culture.
17 Smart-casual events	Polished but relaxed.	Chinos/tailored trousers, knit or shirt, neat shoes, optional light blazer.	Athleisure, worn-out sneakers, very casual T-shirts.	Most ambiguous label globally; ask for examples. Up/down by swapping jacket and shoes.
18 Casual everyday	Comfort and practicality.	Whatever is comfortable, clean and weather-appropriate.	Nothing inherently unsuitable.	Local modesty norms still apply.
19 At home	Comfort; sometimes video calls.	Soft, loose, breathable garments; a presentable top for calls.	-	Rules differ for shared/multigenerational homes.
20 Hot weather	Shed heat; protect from sun.	Loose, breathable, light-to-mid weight; wide-brim hat; UPF long sleeves if sun exposure is long [S8-S9].	Tight, non-breathable synthetics next to skin; wet cotton in wind (chilling).	Loose fit and airflow matter more than colour in the classic desert-robe finding [S6]; modest coverings can be cooler than bare skin in strong sun [E3].

Context	Purpose & common expectations	Commonly suitable	May be unsuitable (why)	Variation, formality dial, and if unsure
21 Cold weather	Retain heat; block wind/wet.	Base layer, insulating mid-layer (wool/fleece), windproof shell; hat/gloves; insulated shoes.	Cotton base layers if sweating/wet (slow drying) [S13 is nuanced].	Layer to adjust; cold hands/feet/head first.
22 Rainy weather	Stay dry, keep visibility, avoid slipping.	Water-resistant shell, quick-drying trousers, grippy shoes; umbrella/hat.	Suede, canvas and long hems that soak; slippery soles.	In humid heat, a full shell may trap sweat; ventilated or poncho-style options.
23 Transitional weather	Handle big daily temperature swings.	Removable layers (cardigan, light jacket), scarf/wrap.	Single heavy garments.	Plan from the coldest and hottest points of the day.
24 First impressions / photos / public appearances	Comfort, confidence, camera and lighting.	Well-fitting familiar clothes; solid or medium-scale patterns; fabrics that do not shine/crush.	Very fine stripes/checks may shimmer on camera; heavy logos.	Lighting changes colour appearance (metamerism) [S40]; test in similar light if possible. No garment guarantees judgement outcomes [S2-S4].

B.3 Garment and accessory taxonomy

Ten attributes per category are grouped into six columns. Formality scale: 1 = very casual, 5 = very formal. Budget bands: \$ very low, \$\$ student/moderate, \$\$\$ premium, \$\$\$\$ luxury; price does not equal quality (see Section C). All E3.

Category	Formality & common fabrics	Climates; colours/patterns	Fit effects & pairs well with	Common mistakes; cultural notes	Care, durability, budget
Shirts (woven)	2-4. Cotton, linen, blends, poplin, oxford	Warm/mild; solid, stripe, check; linen for heat	Shoulder seam at shoulder edge; sleeve to wrist bone; pairs with trousers, jeans, skirts, blazers	Gaping buttons; over-tight collar; ironing skipped. Some cultures favour long shirts worn untucked	Iron/steam; collars wear first. \$-\$\$\$
T-shirts	1-2. Cotton, blends, jersey	All; solids, graphics	Sleeves/torso ease change silhouette; pairs with jeans, layers	Slogans/logos may clash with workplaces or events	Shrinks/pills; low cost. \$-\$\$
Polo shirts	2-3. Cotton pique, technical knit	Warm/mild	Collar shows without tie; pairs with chinos, skirts	Overly clingy pique; collar curling	Durable. \$-\$\$
Blouses	2-4. Cotton, silk, viscose, polyester crepe	Warm/mild; prints/solids	Drape depends on fabric; pairs with trousers/skirts	Sheerness without lining; strain across bust	Delicate care for silk/viscose. \$-\$\$\$
Sweaters / knitwear	2-4. Wool, cotton, acrylic, blends	Cool/cold; layers in AC	Roomier fits layer over shirts; pairs with everything	Pilling; stretching from hanging	Fold to store; wash gently. \$-\$\$\$
Hoodies	1-2. Cotton-poly fleece	Cool	Oversized common; pairs with jeans/joggers	Not suited to strict workplaces or formal events	Durable. \$-\$\$
Jackets (casual)	2-3. Denim, cotton, nylon shell	Mild/wet/cool	Length at hip/waist changes proportion	Too tight to layer; unsuited to rain if not treated	Long-lived. \$-\$\$\$
Blazers	3-4. Wool, blend, linen, cotton	Mild; linen for heat	Shoulder fit hardest to alter; pairs with trousers, jeans, dresses	Sleeves too long; overstuffed pockets	Tailorable at sleeves/waist. \$\$-\$\$\$\$
Coats	2-5. Wool, down, synthetic insulated	Cold/wind	Room for layers; length affects proportion	Buying too tight to layer	Store clean. \$\$-\$\$\$\$
Traditional garments	1-5 by garment	Region-specific fabrics/climate	Often wrapped, draped or loose; sized by measurements or fabric length	Costume framing; wearing restricted items (Section D)	Care by fabric (handwoven, printed, silk). \$-\$\$\$\$
Trousers / pants	2-5. Cotton, wool, linen, synthetics	All	Rise/leg width define silhouette; hem length affects shoe visibility	Hem pooling; tight thigh; waistband gap	Hemming cheap and valuable. \$-\$\$\$
Jeans	1-3. Cotton denim, stretch denim	Mild/cool; heavy for hot humid	Rise/taper/cut; pairs with most tops	Assuming 'always casual' - dark straight jeans can be smart-casual in some offices; not in others	Durable; wash less. \$-\$\$\$
Shorts	1-2. Cotton, technical, linen	Hot	Length affects modesty and formality	Unsuitable where knee-covering expected	\$-\$\$
Skirts	1-4. Cotton, wool, viscose, wraps	All	Length/volume; pairs with tucked tops, knits	Restrictive hems for walking; slip needed for sheer fabric	\$-\$\$\$
Dresses	1-5. All fabrics	All	One-piece simplicity; waist/hem define shape	Poor pocket access; seated comfort	\$-\$\$\$\$

Category	Formality & common fabrics	Climates; colours/patterns	Fit effects & pairs well with	Common mistakes; cultural notes	Care, durability, budget
Jumpsuits	1-4. Cotton, linen, crepe	Warm/mild	Torso length fit is critical; bathroom practicality matters	Torso too short; hard to layer	\$-\$-\$-\$
Suits	4-5. Wool, blends	Mild/cool; light wool or linen blends for heat	Shoulder/jacket fit crucial; can split into separates	Sleeve/trouser length; heavy fabric in heat	Tailoring pays off. \$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Sportswear	1. Polyester/nylon/elastane knits	Hot/cold by design	Compression vs. loose; supports mobility	Cotton in intense sweat (E3); wrong shoe type	Wash cool; odor buildup. \$-\$-\$-\$
Underwear / base layers	n/a. Cotton, modal, merino, synthetics	All	Seam and waistband comfort; shapes under clothes	Wrong fabric for activity; uncomfortable seams for sensory-sensitive people [S16]	Replace regularly. \$-\$-\$
Shoes (closed)	1-5. Leather, canvas, mesh, synthetic	By type	Silhouette base: chunky adds visual weight, slim reduces it	Uncomfortable; not resoleable; wrong for terrain	Resoling extends life. \$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Sandals	1-3. Leather, rubber	Hot	Open toes; pairs with light clothes	Unsuitable in workshops/labs/some workplaces	\$-\$-\$-\$
Boots	2-4. Leather, rubber, suede	Cold/wet/rough	Ankle height alters trouser break	Suede in rain; tight calves	Waterproof care. \$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Belts	1-5. Leather, fabric	All	Ties waist; match to shoe finish is a convention, not a rule	Wrong length; overly stiff	Long-lived. \$-\$-\$-\$
Bags	1-5. Leather, canvas, nylon	All	Size/position changes proportion	Overloading (posture, comfort)	\$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Watches	1-5. Steel, leather, rubber	All	Case size vs wrist	Formal watches with sports outfits (a convention)	Servicing. \$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Jewellery	1-5.	All	Scale/visibility; comfort with movement	Safety hazards for work/sport; cultural or religious symbolism	Variable. \$-\$-\$-\$-\$
Hats / headwear	1-5. Cotton, straw, wool	Sun/cold	Face/head proportion; sun protection: wide brim 3 in+ [S9]	Straw with loose weave gives less UV protection [S9]; religious head coverings are not accessories	Shape care. \$-\$-\$-\$
Scarves / wraps	1-4. Cotton, wool, silk	Cool/AC/sun	Adds layer/colour; can replace extra jacket	Fringes catching; religious/cultural meanings vary [S18-S20]	\$-\$-\$-\$
Ties / formal accessories	4-5. Silk, wool, knit	Formal	Width in proportion to lapel	Knot too tight; local formal alternatives to ties	\$-\$-\$-\$

B.4 Colour and pattern coordination

B.4.1 What the terms do in practice

- **Hue, value, saturation** are the three levers. Most 'these colours match' judgements come down to **value contrast** (light vs dark) and **saturation** (vivid vs muted) more than exact hue [E3, P].
- **Contrast** has two meanings: between garments (e.g. white shirt + navy trousers = high; beige + stone = low) and between garments and the wearer's own colouring. The second is preference, not a rule.
- **Temperature**: warm colours advance visually and cool colours recede; useful as a description, not as a prohibition [E3].
- **The colour wheel** (invented for pigments, refined by artists such as Chevreul and Itten, per the history summarised on Wikipedia's colour-analysis page) gives useful *vocabulary* for combinations but is not a law of clothing: fabric texture, proportion, scale and lighting change results as much as hue does [E3]. Real outfits rely on neutrals more than pure wheel harmonies.

B.4.2 Combination methods

Method	How it works	Clothing example (colours only)	When it helps / caution
Neutral	Blacks, whites, greys, navy, beige/camel, olive, denim, brown. Vary value and texture.	Charcoal trousers + stone knit + white shirt	Safest; can look flat without texture or one contrasting item.
Monochromatic	One hue in several values.	Navy trousers, mid-blue shirt, light-blue scarf	Lengthens the visual line; vary fabric texture to avoid a 'flat' look.

Method	How it works	Clothing example (colours only)	When it helps / caution
Analogous	Neighbouring hues (e.g. green, teal, blue).	Olive jacket, teal top, blue trousers	Harmonious; keep one dominant.
Complementary	Opposite hues (e.g. blue/orange).	Navy jacket with rust knit	Strong; often best with one colour muted or as a small accent.
Split-complementary	One hue + the two neighbours of its opposite.	Blue shirt with coral and yellow-ochre accents	More variety, less clash than pure complementary.
Triadic	Three hues evenly spaced.	Red, yellow, blue in different sizes	Reads bold or playful; mute two of the three.
One statement colour	A single vivid item, rest neutral.	Grey suit + mustard scarf	Easy for small wardrobes; put the statement where the eye should go.
Bright + bright	Combine saturated colours of similar intensity, often separated by a neutral or thin white/black element.	Cobalt + fuchsia with a white belt	Works best when saturation levels match; 'colour-blocking' is a style, not a requirement.
Shoes / belt / bag	Convention: belt and shoe finish coordinate in formal menswear; bags can match or contrast.	Brown shoes + brown belt	Convention [C/Op]; contrast is equally valid in many contexts.

B.4.3 Patterns

- **Scale contrast:** mix patterns of clearly different scale (fine stripe with large floral), not similar ones [E3, Op].
- **Shared colour:** patterns are easier to combine if they share a colour or the same value range.
- **One dominant pattern:** let one item lead; use solids or textures elsewhere.
- **Avoiding visual overload:** a practical heuristic is 3 colours plus neutrals, or 2 patterns plus solids; treat as a starting point, not a rule [E3, Op]. Many traditions layer several bold prints on purpose (e.g. wax-print outfits [S21-S22]); the 'overload' judgement is cultural.
- **Camera and screens:** very fine stripes/checks can shimmer on video [E3].

B.4.4 Skin tone and undertone - handled carefully

Design position. People of every skin tone can wear every colour. The assistant must not state that any colour is 'wrong', 'bad' or 'unflattering' for a skin tone, hair colour, age or culture. Colour suggestions based on appearance must be **opt-in, framed as one option among many, and overridable by the user**.

- **Evidence status: weak.** The only study retrieved (35 subjects) found 40% agreement between observers and analysts and could not group skin tones with a chart [S5]. Commercial pages promote 4- or 12-season systems without evidence [S41]. Classify as [\$/][Op]/[W].
- **Why it can still feel useful:** some people simply like what a consultant or a mirror shows them; colour near the face changes how contrast and complexion look in a photo or mirror. That is an effect of contrast and lighting, not a validated 'rule' [E3].
- **Measurement problems:** lighting changes colour appearance (see B.4.5); cameras and screens shift skin and clothing colours; vein tests and metal tests are unreliable heuristics [E3].

Practical methods to help users discover colours they enjoy (preference-led)

- **Wardrobe mining:** from photos/inventory, list the colours the user wears most and rates as 'confident'; build from those first.
- **Swatch reactions:** show 12-16 neutral and accent swatches; ask 'love / fine / not for me'. Store as preferences, not as skin-tone rules.
- **Try-and-compare:** user holds or wears two colours near the face in daylight and chooses the one they like; repeat 3-4 times.
- **Comfort and meaning:** ask about colours with cultural, religious or personal meaning (e.g. mourning colours, community colours) - these should override generic combos [C].
- **Season/occasion palette:** propose 2 neutrals + 1-2 accents for the current wardrobe and offer a 'stretch' colour to try, not to obey.

B.4.5 Lighting and fabric effects

- **Metamerism:** two items that match under one light can differ under another because light sources have different spectra [S40]; outfits assembled under shop LEDs may look different in daylight. Advise checking in the light where the outfit will be worn.
- **Brightness:** stronger illumination makes colours look more saturated and shows more shadow detail (industry dyeing guidance) [E2].

- **Fabric surface:** gloss, texture and weave change perceived colour even with the same dye; the same colour name on cotton, silk and polyester may not match [E2/E3]. Synthetic fibres can show metameric shifts more than natural ones in some dye systems (industry example in [S40]).

B.4.6 Example palettes

Palette type	Example outfit (colours)	Notes
Neutral	Stone trousers, white tee, taupe cardigan, off-white sneakers	Texture variation prevents flatness.
Low contrast	Sand shirt, camel trousers, tan loafers	Calm, soft; good for warm climates.
High contrast	Black trousers, white shirt, red belt	Sharp; keep accessories minimal.
Warm	Rust top, mustard scarf, brown trousers	Autumn-like; also common in earth-dye traditions.
Cool	Slate blue shirt, grey trousers, silver watch	Restrained; pairs with plain shoes.
Earth-tone	Olive shirt-jacket, khaki trousers, clay-brown shoes	Works in many climates; check that olive is not reserved for uniforms locally.
Monochromatic	Head-to-toe navy in varied textures	Add a white tee or scarf for lift.
Minimalist	Black, white and grey; few pieces	Depends on quality of fit and fabric.
Bold	Cobalt dress with orange sandals	One statement is easier than many.
Traditional / culturally specific	Wax-print wrap and coordinated top in matching print (e.g. Zambian chitenge or West African Dutch wax)	Pattern/colour meanings are named and interpreted locally [S21-S24]; ask, do not assume.

B.5 Fit, proportion and silhouette

Fit term	What it means	Typical visual/comfort effect	Note
Tight / skin-tight	Clothing follows the body with little or no ease.	Emphasises the body's outline; restricts movement in non-stretch fabrics.	Comfort and preference vary; sportswear is designed for it.
Fitted	Close to the body, room to move.	Clean line; more structure.	Often needs tailoring.
Tailored	Shaped to the individual's measurements.	Smooth line at shoulder, waist, hem.	Alterations often cost less than replacing a garment (see budgets).
Relaxed	Extra ease in body and sleeves.	Comfort, airflow; shape less defined.	Good for heat.
Oversized	Deliberately larger, dropped shoulders or wide hems.	Volume; play of proportions.	Balance with a slimmer piece if desired [Pref/T].

Fit checkpoints by area (guidance, E3)

- **Shoulders:** seam at the shoulder's edge; hardest area to alter (jackets).
- **Sleeves:** shirt cuff near the wrist bone; jacket sleeve shows a small shirt cuff if that is the style; arm movement without pulling.
- **Collar:** should let 1-2 fingers fit when buttoned (a convention).
- **Waist:** comfortable seated; belts and elastic waists offer adjustment.
- **Trousers:** rise, thigh ease and hem length determine comfort and line; 'break' choices are style conventions [Pref].
- **Hem length:** affects modesty, safety (tripping) and shoe visibility.
- **Layering:** each outer layer should fit over the inner one without pulling; start with the thinnest layer against skin.
- **Footwear and silhouette:** chunkier shoes visually 'ground' wide trousers; slim shoes suit slimmer legs; heel/sole height changes hem needs [E3].
- **Fabric matters:** stretch fabrics forgive; rigid ones need precise size; drapery fabrics hang differently from stiff ones. Size labels vary across brands and eras [S38-S39], so store body measurements and user 'fit notes'.

No body-type superiority. The assistant must not use rigid body-shape categories (pear, apple, etc.) as constraints. Offer visual-effect descriptions - 'a longer jacket lengthens the line; a cropped one shortens it' - and let users pick what they want to emphasise, hide or ignore.

Accommodating different users

User context	Design guidance for the assistant	Sources / status
Height differences	Offer hem, sleeve and rise options; suggest tailoring hems/sleeves; note that high rise/long line change proportion.	E3
Body sizes and proportions	Use measurements, not labels; offer stretch/adjustable options; never shame or steer toward concealment unless asked.	E3; sizing inconsistency [S38-S39]

User context	Design guidance for the assistant	Sources / status
Mobility needs / physical disability	Ask about dressing ability and seating; prefer elastic waists, larger pulls, magnetic or hook-and-loop closures, open-back or wrap styles, stretch and raglan sleeves.	Documented adaptive features [S17]; barrier categories: mechanical/functional, cultural, sensory [S16]
Sensory sensitivities	Prefer soft seams, tagless labels, non-scratchy fabrics; avoid tight waistbands if reported; ask about textures.	Sensory barrier documented [S16]; specifics E3
Religious / modesty requirements	Never infer; ask. Provide options that meet the user's stated coverage (sleeve, hem, neckline, headwear) in breathable fabrics. Modest dress is diverse across and within faiths and countries.	[S18-S20]
Pregnancy / postpartum	Prefer adjustable/stretch pieces, empire-line or wrap styles, supportive shoes; body size may change quickly. Do not give medical advice.	E3
Occupational requirements	Employer uniform, PPE and safety rules override style. Ask what is mandatory.	E3; safety guidance must come from the employer/authority

B.6 Materials: comparison

Ratings are relative (Low / Med / High) and represent typical garments, not every product. Figures with a source ID come from retrieved sources; the rest is E3. Fabric construction (knit, weave, thickness, finish) can matter as much as fibre: one study found drying time depends mainly on how much water the fabric initially holds, i.e. thickness, rather than fibre regain alone [S13].

Fibre	Breathability	Warmth	Moisture management	Odor resist.	Durability	Dry time	Wrinkle	Cost	Environment; care
Cotton	High	Med	Absorbs (regain 4.7% at 30 min; 7-8.5% at equilibrium [S12, S14]); slow to dry when soaked	Low-Med	Med-High	Slow	Med	Low-Med	Water/pesticide heavy if conventional (E3); easy care
Linen	Very high	Low	Absorbs, dries faster than cotton (E3)	Med	High	Med-Fast	Very high	Med	Low-input crop (E3); wrinkles are part of the look
Wool	Med-High	High	Absorbs (regain 7.0% at 30 min [S12]), stays warm when damp (E3)	High (E3)	Med	Slow	Low	Med-High	Renewable; shrink risk; wash gently
Silk	Med	Med	Absorbs but water-marks	Low-Med	Low-Med	Med	Med	High	Delicate; sweat/sun damage
Denim (cotton)	Med	Med	Like cotton; heavy	Low	Very high	Very slow	Low	Low-High	Water use in finishing (E3); tight weave gives good UV protection [S37]
Leather	Low	Med	Low	Med	Very high	Slow	Low	High	Care needed; ethical/environmental concerns vary
Polyester	Low-Med (varies by knit)	Low-Med	Very low regain (0.3-0.4% [S12, S14]); dries fast; wicks in suitable knits [S15]	Low (E3)	High	Fast	Low	Low	Sheds microfibres [S10]; recycled versions exist
Nylon	Low	Low-Med	Low regain; dries fast (E3)	Low (E3)	Very high	Fast	Low	Low-Med	Petro-based; abrasion resistant
Rayon / viscose	High	Low-Med	Very absorbent (7.4% at 30 min [S12]); weak when wet (E3)	Low	Low-Med	Med	High	Low-Med	Wood-pulp derived; impacts vary by process (E3); handle gently
Modal	High	Low-Med	Absorbent, soft; more stable than basic viscose (E3)	Low	Med	Med	Low-Med	Med	A type of rayon (E3)
Technical sports fabrics	Varies	Varies	Engineered wicking/quick-dry; finishes can wash out (E3)	Varies	High	Fast	Low	Med-High	Check treatments and care; some water-repellent finishes raise chemical concerns (E3)
Blends	Varies	Varies	Combine traits; poly-cotton dries faster than cotton but is less breathable (E3)	Varies	High	Med	Low	Low-Med	Harder to recycle (E3)
Recycled / lower-impact	Varies	Varies	Same as base fibre	Varies	Varies	Varies	Varies	Med-High	Less than 1% of clothing fibre is recycled into new clothing [S10]; claims vary - prefer wearing longer and second-hand

One retrieved practitioner-level claim conflicts with the other: [S14] says polyester is uncomfortable in tropical heat; [S15] says polyester knits outperform cotton for wicking in sports settings. Both can be true (different constructions, activities and finishing).

Recommend 'depends on knit, activity, climate' rather than 'cotton is cooler'.

B.7 Climate and practical needs

Climate	What matters	Typical strategies (E3 unless cited)
Hot and humid	Sweat evaporates poorly; airflow and dryness matter.	Loose, light, breathable garments; open weaves; hats; carry a spare top; UPF for long exposure [S8].
Hot and dry	Sun exposure, dust, fast dehydration.	Loose covering garments can reduce direct sun; colour matters less than airflow and coverage in the Bedouin study [S6] (with its caveats); hats and eye protection.
Cold	Retain heat; avoid sweat build-up.	Layer: base (wicking), insulating mid, wind/water shell; protect head, hands, feet.
Rainy	Stay dry; avoid heavy fabrics that stay wet.	Shells, quick-dry trousers, brimmed hats, grip soles; breathability to avoid internal condensation.
Windy	Convective heat loss; garment flapping.	Windproof shell; secure hats/scarves; avoid loose hems in wind.
High altitude	Cold, strong UV, rapid weather change.	Layers, UV protection, sturdy footwear; follow local safety advice for climbs.
Indoor air-conditioning	Big temperature difference between outdoors and inside.	Carry a light cardigan/wrap; avoid damp sweat-soaked layers.
Seasonal transitions	Large day-night swings.	Add/remove layers; keep a compact rain layer.

B.8 Age and life stage

Age does not determine taste. The assistant should treat age as one contextual signal among many and never restrict styles by age. What changes are *needs*: mobility, comfort, care demands, income and social roles.

Stage	Practical needs to consider	What to avoid
Children	Growth, durability, ease of dressing, safety (drawstrings, fit), school uniform.	Assuming taste from gender; medical or safety claims without reliable sources.
Teenagers	Fast body change, identity exploration, peer influence, budgets.	Body-shaming; pushing 'mature' or 'youthful' looks.
Young adults	Study/work transitions, small wardrobes, mixed budgets.	Assuming trend-following.
Working adults	Dress-code compliance, time pressure, commuting.	Assuming one professional look.
Parents	Washability, mobility, quick changes, breastfeeding-friendly options if wanted.	Assuming loss of interest in style.
Older adults	Ease of fastening, warmth, joint comfort, footwear stability, personal style continuity.	Assuming taste, patronising 'age-appropriate' rules (see myths).
Retired people	Comfort, leisure, social roles, income changes.	Assuming budgets are high or low.

B.9 Clothing for different budgets

Money does not equal quality: cost, brand and construction quality are separate variables [E3]. Verify quality by hands-on checks: seam allowance, stitch density, fabric weight, lining, button anchoring, and whether fabric recovers after stretch.

Budget	Priorities	Where to spend / save	Notes
Very limited	Function, hygiene, safety; 5-10 versatile items.	Second-hand and market clothes; repair/altering; wash and rotation planning.	Second-hand is mainstream and active practice, e.g. Zambian <i>salaula</i> where consumers select, alter and localise garments [S1].
Student	Layers, easy care, interview/presentation outfit.	One good pair of shoes; second-hand blazers; borrowing/renting for events.	Time-poor: capsule of 12-18 pieces.
Moderate	Fit and durability of frequently worn items.	Tailoring for trousers/jackets; better shoes.	Cost per wear.
Premium	Construction quality, fabric, resoleable shoes.	Repairable pieces; timeless cuts.	Price still does not prove quality.
Luxury	Craft, provenance, investment pieces.	Same as premium; buy fewer.	Wear-frequency rules still apply; luxury is a preference, not a requirement.

- **Tailoring vs. buying new:** alterations (hems, sleeves, waist, taking in seams) usually cost less than a replacement and can save a well-made garment [E3]. Poor shoulder fit in jackets is the hardest and most expensive to fix.

- **Highest-combination garments** (usually): a neutral trouser, a neutral knit/cardigan, a plain shirt/T-shirt, a mid-layer jacket, comfortable shoes [E3].
- **Second-hand, rental and markets:** extends lifespan; check hygiene/care, fit and fabric condition. Rental suits one-off formal events (hanbok rental is described as typical in Korea [S33]).
- **Cost per wear** = price / wears; compare expected wears, care cost and replacement, not just price.
- **Avoiding overbuying:** fewer new items, more repeat outfits; industry analysis estimates falling garment utilisation and low recycling [S10-S11]. The assistant should support reuse without guilt-tripping.
- **Care for longevity:** wash less, at lower temperature, following labels; air dry; repair buttons/seams early; store dry [E3].

B.10 Wardrobe-building and organisation strategy

Task	Method (E3)	What the assistant needs
Inventory clothes	Photo capture per item; note category, colour, fabric, condition, fit, comfort, occasions.	Photo upload or guided form; allow 'unknown'.
Find missing basics	Compare inventory to a context checklist (climate, workplace, activities).	User context + item counts by role.
Spot duplicates	Cluster near-identical items (same category+colour+formality).	Similarity scoring; user confirmation.
Create combinations	Generate outfits from compatible items by formality, colour, season.	Compatibility model (Section G).
Plan in advance	Weekly plan from calendar/weather; note laundry cycles.	Calendar/weather; laundry state.
Limited clothing	Rotate layers and accessories; choose one 'repeatable' formula.	Available-items list.
Clothes that do not fit	Tag: needs alteration / seasonal / life-stage change / donate; avoid pressure to discard.	User goals; alteration options.
Laundry availability	Track clean/dirty/needs-repair; offer 'wear again' guidance for low-soil items.	Laundry state; hygiene norms differ.
Travel packing	Pack around 2-3 neutrals + accents; layers; one dressy option; shoe limit.	Trip length, climate, activities.
A week of outfits	Anchor pieces repeat; vary tops/accessories.	Week plan.
Dress quickly	Pre-made 'formulas' (top + bottom + shoe); saved 'go-to' outfits.	User's confident outfits.

C. Practical styling rules

Each rule is a **default the assistant may suggest**, never a requirement. 'Type' uses the claim tags from A.2. 'Evidence' is E3 unless a source ID is given.

C.1 Concise rulebook

#	Rule	Why it works	Exceptions / caveats	Type; evidence
1	Start from context: purpose, dress code, weather, activities, then wardrobe.	Most bad outfits are context mismatches, not taste failures.	Safety or religious requirements override style.	[P]; E3
2	Fit and comfort first: choose garments that fit the body <i>today</i> and allow the needed movement.	Poor fit distracts wearer and changes silhouette regardless of price.	Deliberate oversize is a valid style; size labels are unreliable [S38-S39].	[P]/[Pref]; E3
3	Keep top, bottom and shoes within about one formality step of each other unless the mix is intentional.	Large gaps look accidental in many workplaces.	Streetwear and some traditions deliberately mix formal and casual.	[C]; E3
4	Build on neutrals; add one accent colour or pattern.	Easy to combine; reduces overload.	Many traditions favour multiple bright colours [S21-S22].	[P]/[Pref]; E3
5	Vary value (light/dark) and texture when colours are similar.	Prevents flatness in monochrome and low-contrast outfits.	Flat colour can be a deliberate minimalist style.	[P]; E3
6	When mixing patterns, vary the scale and share a colour or value range.	Gives hierarchy and unity.	Some styles use similar patterns intentionally.	[Op]/[Pref]; E3
7	Choose footwear for the activity first, then for style.	Shoes cause the most comfort/safety problems.	Dress codes may require specific shoes.	[P]; E3
8	Layer thin-to-thick; put moisture-managing layers next to skin in cold or active settings.	Layers can be adjusted as temperature changes.	Very hot climates need single light layers; check fabrics [B.6].	[P]; E3
9	In heat, prioritise airflow, looseness and shade over colour alone.	Bedouin-robe study: extra heat absorbed by black robes was lost before reaching skin [S6].	Study is small and specific to loose robes; fitted dark clothing is different; UV protection benefits from dark/tight weaves [S8-S9].	[P] (weak-moderate); [S6, S7]
10	For long sun exposure choose tightly woven, heavier, dry fabrics and a wide-brim hat.	UPF depends on weave, colour, weight, stretch, wetness [S8-S9].	UPF-rated light fabrics can protect well; stretch and wetness reduce protection.	[P]; E2 [S8-S9]
11	Avoid relying on cotton alone for wet, cold, high-sweat activity.	Absorbent fabrics can stay damp (E3); drying time depends on thickness/construction too [S13].	Wool and blends behave differently; thin cotton dries fast in warm air.	[P] (nuanced); E3, [S12-S13]
12	Check colours in the lighting you'll be in (daylight vs indoor).	Colours that match in one light can shift in another [S40].	Can't always test; buy from stores with return options.	[P]; E2 [S40]
13	Tailor hems and sleeves before buying replacements.	Small alterations often fix the most visible fit problems.	Shoulders and torso length are hard to alter.	[P]/[\$]; E3
14	Match belt/shoe finish in formal menswear if unsure.	A convention that avoids attention.	Not a rule in most casual or non-Western contexts.	[C]/[Op]; E3
15	Pick fabrics for care reality (ironing, dry cleaning, washing frequency).	Clothes you cannot maintain sit unused.	Rental/dry-cleaning access varies.	[P]; E3
16	Use the 'sit-reach-walk' test before an event.	Reveals restrictions, gaps, and slipping straps.	Not a health test.	[P]; E3
17	When unsure of the dress code: ask, look at photos, dress one notch up, carry an extra layer.	Cheaper to remove a layer than to fix an under-dressed mismatch.	Over-dressing can also be awkward in casual cultures.	[C]; E3
18	For cultural or religious garments: ask hosts, buy from makers, learn names and meanings; don't wear sacred/restricted items as costume.	Reduces harm and shows respect.	Rules differ by community; some invite guests to wear items.	[C]; E2 [S27-S28, S35-S36]
19	Never infer modesty, religion, gender expression or ability from appearance; ask what the user needs.	Prevents stereotyping.	-	[P]; product policy
20	Always offer a cheaper/fewer-item alternative.	Respects budgets and small wardrobes.	-	[P]; product policy

C.2 Common myths and mistakes - evaluated

Claim	Classification	Evaluation and evidence
Certain colours cannot be worn by certain skin tones	Unsupported claim; potentially harmful stereotype	The only retrieved study found 40% agreement and could not group tones [S5]; other material is commercial [S41]. Use optional, preference-based suggestions.
Certain body types should never wear certain garments	Outdated rule; potentially harmful stereotype	No evidence base; fit, comfort and preference vary. Offer visual-effect descriptions instead.
Men should not care about fashion	Unsupported claim; potentially harmful stereotype	Men's dress cultures are extensive (e.g. Asante kente historically worn by royalty [S28]; men's chitenge in some regions [S24-S25]; dhoti in India [E3]).
Expensive clothing always looks better	Unsupported claim	Fit, fabric and construction determine appearance; price and quality are distinct variables. Second-hand clothes are actively selected and altered [S1].
Matching every item is necessary	Outdated rule / personal preference	Coordination matters more than matching; deliberate contrast is common.
Black always goes with everything	Context-dependent advice	Blacks vary (fade, undertone); black is a mourning colour in many contexts (E3); may be too stark next to some colours.
Fashion rules are universal	Unsupported claim	Conventions vary with place, sector and community [S1, S18-S19, S21-S22].
Older people should dress a certain way	Outdated rule; potentially harmful stereotype	Needs (mobility, warmth, fastenings) change; taste does not follow age. Focus on comfort and identity.
Certain clothes automatically make someone professional	Context-dependent advice	Professionalism is defined by workplace norms; clothing effects on the wearer are modest and contested [S2-S4].
A person's clothing reveals their character	Unsupported claim; potentially harmful stereotype	Product must never infer traits from clothes.
Dark clothes are always hotter	Context-dependent	Loose dark robes did not add heat load in one study [S6]; dark fabrics absorb more UV [S8].
Cotton is always best in heat	Context-dependent	Cotton absorbs [S12, S14]; some sportswear knits wick better [S15]; construction matters [S13].
Size labels are consistent	Unsupported claim	No global standard; brand labels vary [S38-S39].

D. Cultural and regional comparison

Non-hierarchical framing. No region is presented as more or less fashionable. Examples are illustrative, cover only a few countries and are drawn from a small set of retrieved sources; they must not be used as definitive descriptions of any culture. Each cultural example says whether it is everyday, ceremonial, religious or fashion; internal diversity is noted where sources give it.

D.1 Regional comparison

Region	Influences (climate, history, economy)	Examples and status	Respectful, non-stereotyped use in the assistant	Sources
Southern Africa (Zambia focus)	Warm climate with cool/hot/rainy seasons (E3). Colonial and postcolonial trade; liberalised import of secondhand clothing; local textile industry under pressure [S1 (publisher description via FIT database entry)].	Chitenge: everyday, ceremonial and funeral cloth in rural areas per one travel-company essay [S24]; used as wrap skirt, headscarf, baby sling; secondhand ('salaula') clothing is an everyday, actively selected and altered source of clothing [S1].	Treat secondhand as normal. Note conflicting popular sources: one says Malawian men never wear chitenje [S24], another says men did not until a presidential Friday-wear campaign [S25]; a 2010 blog says chitenges sold in Zambia were imported and less used in Lusaka [S26]. Present as 'reported, varies'; ask user.	S1, S24-S26
West Africa	Global trade in textiles; Dutch industrial batik imitation; women traders' networks.	Wax print: fashion/everyday/ceremonial; status product in several countries [S22]; women traders ('Nana-Benz') built wealth on the trade [S21]. Kente: Asante/Ewe woven cloth with royal and ceremonial history; printed versions are mass-produced [S27-S28].	Wax print has Indonesian-Dutch-African layers of origin; curators argue it became a self-made African identity [S21]. Kente meanings are specific to weavers/patterns; wearing it as generic 'African costume' is inappropriate; ask/buy from weavers. The 'returning soldiers brought cloth' origin story cannot be proven [S23].	S21-S23, S27-S28, S42
Middle East / Muslim contexts	Climate (heat, sun), religious norms, modernity and consumer culture.	Bedouin robes: loose, often dark, everyday [S6]. Modest/pious fashion: varies by country and person; fieldwork in Iran, Indonesia and Turkey shows tremendous variety [S18]; hijab styles in Britain show diverse colours, textures and layering [S19]; modest dress also exists among Jewish, Christian and secular women [S20].	Never assume that a Muslim user wears any particular item or that Islamic dress equals Arab dress [S18]. Ask about coverage needs; treat as personal choice.	S6, S18-S20
South Asia	Heat/monsoon, region and community identity, mills and handloom, colonial history.	Sari: worn as everyday, working and ceremonial dress; drape, fabric and pattern can express religious belief, custom, region, class and personal taste [S30]; drape traditions are under-documented [S31]; counts of drapes vary (80+ vs 108) [S32].	Describe as 'many regional drapes'; ask which the user wears. Do not equate sari with a single national costume.	S30-S32
East Asia	Modernisation, rapid change in everyday dress.	Hanbok: everyday to ceremonial within roughly a century; rental is common; South Korea set Hanbok Day in 1996 [S33-S34]; interest in 'everyday hanbok' expanded from the 1990s [S43]. Kimono: not researched here.	Offer hanbok/kimono only in ceremonial or festive contexts as the user chooses; do not equate East Asia with traditional dress.	S33-S34, S43
Latin America (Mexico)	Indigenous heritage, textile tradition, colonial history, tourism and fashion markets.	Huipil: a loose tunic worn by Indigenous women in Mexico and Central America for over a thousand years [S44]; community-specific embroidery/weaving. Indigenous groups and Mexican authorities have accused foreign brands of copying designs; a 2022 federal law protects Indigenous and Afro-Mexican cultural heritage [S35-S36].	Never label community designs 'Aztec', 'boho' or 'ethnic'; recommend buying from artisans/cooperatives with credit. Legal disputes are allegations reported by media unless adjudicated.	S35-S36, S44
Europe / North America	Industrial garment production, business dress conventions, secondhand donation flows, fast fashion.	Business suit and casualisation trends (E3, not researched); regional festive dress (E3, not researched). Wear frequency decreased ~36% over 15 years (EMF) and less than 1% of clothing fibre is recycled into new clothing [S10-S11].	Do not treat Western workplace norms as the default. Many Western garments end up in Africa as secondhand clothing [S1].	S1, S10-S11

D.2 Cultural respect matrix (guidance, E3)

Garment / practice	Status	May be respectful / ordinary	Context-dependent or inappropriate
Chitenge wrap (Zambia, wider region)	Everyday, ceremonial	Buying and wearing locally as offered; using for practical wrap skirt or sling is ordinary [S24, S26].	Assuming one meaning per pattern; imitating cultural dress as a fancy-dress costume.
Wax-print clothing	Fashion, everyday, ceremonial	Buying from African designers/vendors; wearing everyday is common [S22].	Presenting it as 'traditional tribal wear'; naming its meaning without knowing the print's local name.
Kente	Ceremonial, status	Buying from weavers; wearing stoles/accessories where welcomed (exhibition materials document kente accessories such as cummerbunds and bow ties [S29]).	Casual copy printing; ceremonial or royal contexts.
Sari	Everyday, ceremonial	Wearing when invited or advised by hosts; asking about drape.	Treating as a costume; ignoring regional and religious meanings [S30].
Hanbok / kimono	Ceremonial, festive	Rental or purchase for festive contexts as hosts or vendors offer [S33].	Mocking or sexualised 'versions'.
Huipil / Indigenous textiles	Everyday, ceremonial, community-owned designs	Buying directly from artisans; crediting community.	Reproducing designs without credit [S35-S36].
Hijab / religious head-coverings	Religious/modesty (and fashion)	Respecting the wearer's choice; not commenting or requesting changes [S18-S20].	Treating as an accessory or trend.

D.3 Other influences on dress

Influence	How it shapes clothing (E3 unless cited)	Implication for the assistant
Colonial and postcolonial history	Imposed dress codes, trade in cloth, secondhand flows, later assertion of national/regional dress [S1, S21].	Avoid describing 'Western' as the neutral default.
Social class and economic access	Access to fabrics, alterations, laundry, rentals; secondhand is common [S1].	Budget as first-class input; never shame.
Occupation	Uniforms, PPE, tool constraints.	Ask what's mandatory.
Gender expression	Garment categories differ by culture; many traditional garments are worn by all genders (e.g. wraps).	Use the user's stated preferences; don't map garments to gender.
Age / life stage	See B.8.	Needs, not taste.
Urban vs rural	Practicality (dust, walking), local textile access.	Ask environment, not assumptions.
Music and youth subcultures; sports	Sportswear crossover, uniforms as fashion.	Treat as trends unless supported.
Migration and globalisation; social media	Diaspora dress, trend spread, fast copying of designs; cultural-appropriation disputes [S36].	Give provenance and credit; caution with viral looks.
Local fashion industries	Designers and tailors working with local textiles; e.g. Dutch wax used by designers in Ghana and abroad [S28].	Prefer local makers where the user wants.

D.4 Public-figure and street-style research - limits and template

What was and was not done. The brief asks for analysis of specific outfits worn by musicians, actors, athletes, business leaders, politicians, designers and street-style communities. **I did not analyse individual celebrity outfits**, because this pass did not retrieve reliable, dated, well-documented outfit records for named individuals and I will not invent details. Instead this section documents public-figure *clothing decisions and institutions* that were found in sources, gives a template for analysing outfits, and lists what must be sourced next.

Documented example (public figure / institution)	What is documented	Category and adaptability	Source
Malawian president's Friday chitenje campaign	Civil servants encouraged to wear chitenje to promote local products (reported on a weak encyclopaedic source; needs verification).	Policy/publicity; adaptable idea: 'local-fabric Fridays' for workplaces.	S25 (weak)
South Korea's Hanbok Day (1996)	Ministry established the day to encourage wearing hanbok.	Cultural policy; ceremonial/festive dress rather than daily dress.	S34
Nana-Benz wax-print traders (West Africa)	Women traders built commercial success trading Dutch wax; named after the car they could afford.	Business history; not an outfit; shows cloth as capital.	S21

Documented example (public figure / institution)	What is documented	Category and adaptability	Source
Susana Harp (Mexican singer and politician) calling out a French designer over Mixe designs	Public criticism in 2020; brand later accused of copying; a French court reportedly ruled the Mixe community owns the designs (reported by a media outlet; not verified against the ruling).	Advocacy; shows public-figure influence on norms of credit.	S36 (and a Remezcla report)
Asantehene wearing kente (photo caption)	Kente associated with Asante royalty and special occasions.	Ceremonial dress; not adaptable as everyday copy.	S28

Outfit-analysis template for future work

Field	Guidance
Occasion / context	Event, date, source, audience; performance or public appearance?
Garments, palette, fit, silhouette, accessories	Record what is visible and documented; do not guess fabrics from photos.
Cultural context	Garment status (everyday/ceremonial/religious/fashion), community, maker if known.
Practicality for everyday users	Weather, mobility, care, cost.
Adaptable parts	Proportions, colour logic, layering formula - not identity, branding or lifestyle.
Not adaptable	Performance costume, publicity styling, couture prices, brand deals, sacred items.
Lasting principle vs trend	Classify explicitly; require at least two independent sources for 'lasting'.
Ethics	Do not rank attractiveness or infer personality; avoid using one person as representative of a culture.

Categories to keep separate in future analyses: (1) clothing useful to ordinary people (e.g. layering formulas, neutral bases); (2) clothing designed for performance, publicity, photography or branding (stage costumes, red-carpet couture, sponsored kit); (3) expensive or hard-to-reproduce clothing (couture, bespoke suits); (4) temporary trends (viral micro-styles); (5) lasting styling principles (fit, colour coordination, layering).

E. Outfit examples

Status. These 52 examples are **illustrative design examples (E3)**. They are not empirically validated and not based on any individual's dress. 'Level' refers to the four recommendation levels in Section F: L1 Safe and practical, L2 Polished and versatile, L3 Stylish but low-risk, L4 Creative and experimental. Garment names are general categories, not brands. Gender is not assumed: pieces are described by function and can be worn by anyone; explicit gender-expression variants appear in outfits 45-47. Culturally specific outfits include a context note and are shown only as examples to be confirmed with hosts, community members or local experts.

#1 Warm-weather office, smart casual			
Occasion	Office (business casual)	Climate	Hot and humid
Formality	Smart casual - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Student budget; medium wardrobe
Garments	Short-sleeve or rolled long-sleeve shirt, chino-style trousers		
Colors	Pale blue shirt, stone trousers, brown shoes	Materials	Cotton-linen blend shirt; cotton twill trousers
Fit	Relaxed shirt (room at chest/arms), straight trousers	Footwear	Leather or faux-leather loafers, no-show socks
Accessories	Simple watch, canvas belt		
Why it works	Loose breathable fabrics manage heat; neutral base with one light accent keeps it professional.		
Alternatives	Skirt or lightweight culottes instead of trousers; polo instead of shirt; sneakers if the workplace allows.		
Cultural / practical	Check workplace norms; linen wrinkles by design. E3.		

#2 Air-conditioned office layers			
Occasion	Office	Climate	Hot outside, cold indoors (AC)
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any budget; small wardrobe
Garments	Sleeveless or short-sleeve top, knee-length skirt or trousers, light cardigan		
Colors	Cream top, navy skirt/trousers, grey cardigan	Materials	Viscose or cotton top; cotton-blend cardigan
Fit	Regular fit; cardigan slightly roomy to sit over top	Footwear	Closed flats or low block heels
Accessories	Light scarf kept in bag		
Why it works	Layers let the wearer adjust between heat and AC (see B.7).		
Alternatives	Blazer instead of cardigan; denim instead of skirt.		
Cultural / practical	Avoid damp sweat-soaked layers in AC (E3).		

#3 Interview, conventional sector			
Occasion	Job interview (finance/law/government)	Climate	Mild
Formality	Formal business - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate; medium wardrobe
Garments	Two-piece suit or tailored jacket with matching trousers/skirt, plain shirt or blouse		
Colors	Navy suit, white/light blue shirt, dark shoes	Materials	Wool blend suit; cotton shirt
Fit	Tailored; sleeve/hem adjusted	Footwear	Clean leather shoes, broken in
Accessories	Simple bag/folder, minimal jewellery		
Why it works	Matches usual sector conventions; broken-in shoes prevent distraction.		
Alternatives	Separates (jacket + dark trousers); suit rental; second-hand blazer with alterations.		
Cultural / practical	Do not infer character from clothes; effects are modest [S2-S4]. Ask about dress code.		

#4 Interview, creative sector, low budget			
Occasion	Job interview (design/media/start-up)	Climate	Mild/warm
Formality	Smart casual - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Very limited; small wardrobe
Garments	Dark jeans (no rips), plain shirt or knit, thrifted blazer		
Colors	Indigo jeans, white shirt, charcoal blazer	Materials	Denim, cotton, wool blend blazer
Fit	Straight jeans; blazer tailored at sleeves	Footwear	Clean sneakers or simple boots
Accessories	One interesting item (scarf or pin)		
Why it works	Signals care while matching a relaxed sector; thrift + small tailoring keeps cost low.		
Alternatives	Chinos instead of jeans; cardigan instead of blazer.		
Cultural / practical	Second-hand is mainstream [S1].		

#5 Business meeting in wax-print tailoring			
Occasion	Business meeting (regional business dress)	Climate	Warm
Formality	Business/fashion - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate; tailor-made
Garments	Tailored wax-print shirt-jacket or dress, plain trousers or skirt		
Colors	Bold print jacket with navy or black plain bottoms	Materials	Cotton wax-print cloth
Fit	Tailored fit made to measure	Footwear	Closed leather shoes or elegant flats
Accessories	Neutral bag		
Why it works	Pattern used on one garment with neutral bottoms; tailoring makes it work-appropriate.		
Alternatives	Wax-print scarf or pocket square on a plain suit.		
Cultural / practical	Wax-print outfits are everyday and fashionable in many West/Central African contexts [S21-S22]; check workplace norms; credit local designers.		

#6 Lecture day, small wardrobe			
Occasion	University class	Climate	Warm, occasional rain
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Student budget; small wardrobe (10 items)
Garments	T-shirt, jeans or joggers, light hoodie or cardigan		
Colors	White tee, blue jeans, grey cardigan	Materials	Cotton jersey, denim
Fit	Regular/relaxed	Footwear	Comfortable sneakers
Accessories	Backpack, water bottle		
Why it works	Simple layers and neutral base give many combinations.		
Alternatives	Skirt or shorts if warmer; jacket if rainy.		
Cultural / practical	Follow lab/workshop shoe safety rules.		

#7 Presentation day, one notch up			
Occasion	University presentation	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Student budget; small wardrobe
Garments	Plain shirt/blouse, dark trousers or skirt, blazer or knit		
Colors	White or light blue top, black bottoms, navy blazer	Materials	Cotton, polyester blend blazer
Fit	Regular; blazer shoulders fitted	Footwear	Clean sneakers or flats
Accessories	Lanyard/ID		
Why it works	Higher contrast and structure signals effort; comfortable shoes for standing.		
Alternatives	Knit cardigan instead of blazer.		
Cultural / practical	E3.		

#8 First date, café			
Occasion	Date (daytime)	Climate	Mild
Formality	Casual-smart - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Any; medium wardrobe
Garments	Soft knit, trousers or skirt, light jacket		
Colors	Terracotta knit, dark trousers, tan jacket	Materials	Wool or cotton knit, denim/cotton
Fit	Comfortable, one item with shape	Footwear	Boots or clean sneakers
Accessories	Small bag, one ring/necklace		
Why it works	Comfort lets the wearer focus on the moment; one warm colour adds interest.		
Alternatives	Dress + cardigan; button-up + chinos.		
Cultural / practical	Preference-based. E3.		

#9 Dinner date, restaurant			
Occasion	Date (evening)	Climate	Mild/cool
Formality	Smart casual/formal - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate; medium wardrobe
Garments	Dress or shirt with tailored trousers, jacket or wrap		
Colors	Deep green dress or black trousers with cream shirt	Materials	Crepe, cotton, wool
Fit	Regular fit; sitting comfort checked	Footwear	Block heels, loafers or boots
Accessories	Jewellery of choice, clutch		
Why it works	Well-fitting pieces with slight formality suit a restaurant.		
Alternatives	Skirt + blouse; suit separates.		
Cultural / practical	Check the venue dress code. E3.		

#10 Wedding guest, semi-formal			
Occasion	Wedding guest	Climate	Warm
Formality	Semi-formal - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Midi dress or lightweight suit/separates		
Colors	Sage green dress or grey linen suit	Materials	Linen blend, viscose crepe
Fit	Regular; comfortable when dancing	Footwear	Block heels or dress shoes
Accessories	Shawl, light jewellery		
Why it works	Avoids the couple's colour theme and stays comfortable through a long day.		
Alternatives	Two-piece set; jumpsuit.		
Cultural / practical	Invitations, culture and religion matter; avoid white unless requested. E3.		

#11 West African wedding, matching cloth			
Occasion	Wedding (traditional/ceremonial)	Climate	Hot
Formality	Formal traditional - L1 Safe (invited)	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate; tailored
Garments	Coordinated outfit in the family's chosen cloth, tailored as top and wrap/skirt or agbada-style set		
Colors	As specified by the hosts	Materials	Cotton wax print, lace or other family-chosen cloth
Fit	Made to measure	Footwear	Dress shoes/sandals; head wrap or cap if customary
Accessories	Jewellery per custom		
Why it works	Following host-chosen colours and cloth honours the occasion.		
Alternatives	Ask hosts for accepted alternatives.		
Cultural / practical	Group cloth conventions exist in some communities (E3, not sourced here). Ask hosts; wax print history is layered [S21-S23].		

#12 South Asian wedding, guest in sari			
Occasion	Wedding (guest)	Climate	Warm
Formality	Formal ceremonial - L1 Safe (invited)	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate; borrowed or purchased
Garments	Sari with blouse and petticoat, or salwar-kameez/lehenga as hosts suggest		
Colors	Jewel tones or hosts' palette	Materials	Silk or blended silk, cotton
Fit	Draped/tailored; safety pins/comfortable waist	Footwear	Sandals or embellished flats
Accessories	Bangles, small clutch		
Why it works	Follows local norms; sari draping expresses region and taste [S30].		
Alternatives	Borrow from a friend; ask which drape is suitable.		
Cultural / practical	Ask hosts what guests wear; drape styles vary widely and are under-documented [S30-S31]. Wearing as costume is inappropriate.		

#13 Funeral or memorial, cool weather			
Occasion	Funeral	Climate	Cool
Formality	Formal subdued - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any; small wardrobe
Garments	Dark or muted long-sleeve top, trousers or knee-length skirt, coat		
Colors	Black, charcoal, dark navy	Materials	Wool, cotton, blends
Fit	Regular; nothing tight or short	Footwear	Closed dark shoes
Accessories	Minimal jewellery; scarf for head covering if customary		
Why it works	Subdued, modest layers respect mourners.		
Alternatives	Dark dress + cardigan; suit.		
Cultural / practical	Mourning colours differ (black common in many contexts, white in some) - ask a relative/elder (E3).		

#14 Funeral, rural Southern Africa (as customary)			
Occasion	Funeral or memorial	Climate	Warm
Formality	Formal, culture-specific - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Low; may be lent
Garments	Dark dress or top with a chitenge wrap and headscarf where customary		
Colors	Dark base; wrap in family-appropriate print	Materials	Cotton
Fit	Wrap secured at waist	Footwear	Closed flat shoes or sandals
Accessories	Head wrap		
Why it works	One traditional source reports chitenge customary at funerals and rituals in rural Southern Africa [S24]; pattern choice may matter locally.		
Alternatives	Ask family about colours/prints.		
Cultural / practical	Weak source; local practice varies by community. Always ask the family.		

#15 Mosque visit, modest coverage (as chosen)			
Occasion	Religious event / visit	Climate	Warm
Formality	Modest - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Long loose tunic or shirt, loose trousers or long skirt, scarf to cover hair if the wearer or place requires		
Colors	Muted or bright as chosen	Materials	Cotton or viscose, breathable
Fit	Loose; no transparency	Footwear	Easy-remove shoes
Accessories	Scarf/prayer shawl as needed		
Why it works	Covers according to the user's stated requirements or the place's rules; breathable in heat.		
Alternatives	Ask the place of worship for rules.		
Cultural / practical	Modest dress is diverse across and within communities [S18-S20]. Do not assume; ask.		

#16 Church or community service, smart casual			
Occasion	Religious event	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Shirt/blouse, trousers or skirt, cardigan or jacket		
Colors	Soft blue, beige, dark trousers	Materials	Cotton, wool blends
Fit	Regular fit	Footwear	Closed shoes
Accessories	Modest jewellery		
Why it works	Neat, comfortable clothes appropriate to many services.		
Alternatives	Dress + cardigan.		
Cultural / practical	Norms differ by tradition; ask a member.		

#17 Family celebration in hanbok (rental)			
Occasion	Cultural ceremony (Korea)	Climate	Mild
Formality	Ceremonial - L1 Safe (invited)	Budget / wardrobe	Rental
Garments	Hanbok jeogori and chima/baji set		
Colors	Vivid or pastel per family	Materials	Silk/polyester rental hanbok
Fit	Fitted at chest, full skirt or trousers	Footwear	Traditional shoes or plain flats
Accessories	Hair ornament as customary		
Why it works	Ceremonial dress for festivals and family events; rental is common [S33].		
Alternatives	Modern everyday hanbok for lighter events [S43].		
Cultural / practical	Everyday to ceremonial shift over ~100 years [S33].		

#18 Graduation with kente accent (bought from weavers)			
Occasion	Graduation / cultural event	Climate	Warm
Formality	Formal - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Formal outfit plus a kente stole, cummerbund or bow tie		
Colors	Formal base in black/white; kente in its own colours	Materials	Cotton or silk kente accent
Fit	Standard formal fit	Footwear	Dress shoes
Accessories	Kente accessory		
Why it works	One symbolic piece on a neutral base honours heritage without costume effect.		
Alternatives	Local woven fabric from another maker.		
Cultural / practical	Kente has royal and ceremonial associations [S27-S28]; accessories documented in exhibitions [S29]. Buy from weavers; avoid generic 'African print' substitutions.		

#19 Warm-night party			
Occasion	Party/nightlife	Climate	Hot
Formality	Casual party - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Breathable shirt or top, dark trousers/skirt, one statement item		
Colors	Black bottoms, patterned top	Materials	Viscose, cotton
Fit	Regular; easy to dance in	Footwear	Comfortable sandals or sneakers
Accessories	Statement earrings/watch		
Why it works	Dark bottoms hide spills; breathable top handles heat.		
Alternatives	Dress; co-ord set.		
Cultural / practical	Check venue policies. E3.		

#20 Cold-night outing			
Occasion	Party/nightlife	Climate	Cold
Formality	Casual party - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Thin base layer, knit, statement jacket		
Colors	Black with one bold jacket	Materials	Merino/cotton, wool coat
Fit	Layers shaped, not bulky	Footwear	Boots
Accessories	Gloves, scarf		
Why it works	Base layers keep warm; statement jacket becomes the focus.		
Alternatives	Long coat; blazer.		
Cultural / practical	E3.		

#21 Family dinner, washable			
Occasion	Family event	Climate	Mild
Formality	Neat casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Button shirt or knit, trousers/skirt		
Colors	Warm neutrals with soft colour	Materials	Cotton, polyester blends
Fit	Regular	Footwear	Comfortable shoes
Accessories	Light scarf		
Why it works	Washable and comfortable across ages.		
Alternatives	Dress or smart jeans.		
Cultural / practical	Holiday dress varies by family.		

#22 Long-haul flight			
Occasion	Travel	Climate	Variable
Formality	Casual comfort - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any; small wardrobe
Garments	Stretch trousers, soft tee, cardigan/hoodie, large scarf		
Colors	Navy/grey neutrals	Materials	Cotton-elastane, wool blend
Fit	Relaxed with some stretch	Footwear	Slip-on shoes, thin socks
Accessories	Compression socks if wanted (medical advice out of scope)		
Why it works	Layers manage cabin temperature; slip-ons ease security.		
Alternatives	Joggers; long dress.		
Cultural / practical	No medical advice provided.		

#23 City walking and site visit			
Occasion	Travel (heat, religious sites)	Climate	Hot
Formality	Casual-smart - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Loose shirt, light long trousers, scarf, hat		
Colors	Sand, white, olive	Materials	Linen, cotton
Fit	Relaxed	Footwear	Closed comfortable walking sandals or shoes
Accessories	Scarf for shoulders/head if required		
Why it works	Loose long layers protect from sun and fit modest site rules.		
Alternatives	Long skirt.		
Cultural / practical	Check destination rules; UPF [S8-S9].		

#24 Day hike with sun exposure			
Occasion	Outdoor activity	Climate	Sunny, mild
Formality	Athletic - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Long-sleeve UPF top, hiking trousers, wide-brim hat		
Colors	Neutral with light hat	Materials	Tightly woven synthetic or blends
Fit	Relaxed, allows arm movement	Footwear	Trail shoes
Accessories	Sunglasses, sunscreen, water		
Why it works	UPF depends on weave, weight and dryness [S8-S9].		
Alternatives	Long-sleeve cotton shirt in tight weave.		
Cultural / practical	Follow local trail safety guidance.		

#25 Hot-day running			
Occasion	Running/exercise	Climate	Hot
Formality	Athletic - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Technical tee, shorts, cap		
Colors	Light colours	Materials	Polyester knit
Fit	Fitted but not tight	Footwear	Supportive running shoes
Accessories	Cap, water		
Why it works	Polyester knits wick well in sportswear studies [S15].		
Alternatives	Cotton tee for a short easy run.		
Cultural / practical	Use local safety advice.		

#26 Modest running outfit (as chosen)			
Occasion	Running/exercise	Climate	Warm
Formality	Athletic - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Long-sleeve breathable top, leggings, running skirt or shorts as chosen, sports head covering if wanted		
Colors	Any	Materials	Technical knit
Fit	Fitted but not tight	Footwear	Running shoes
Accessories	Sports hijab or cap		
Why it works	Modest sports clothing exists in breathable fabrics [S19].		
Alternatives	Loose tunic.		
Cultural / practical	Ask, do not assume.		

#27 Gym session			
Occasion	Gym/sports	Climate	Any indoor
Formality	Athletic - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Low-moderate; small wardrobe
Garments	Stretch top, stretch bottoms or shorts		
Colors	Dark neutral with one bright accent	Materials	Polyester/elastane or cotton-blend knit
Fit	Fitted enough to avoid catching equipment	Footwear	Supportive training shoes
Accessories	Small towel, water		
Why it works	Stretch and moisture management support movement.		
Alternatives	Old cotton tee for light workouts.		
Cultural / practical	Follow gym rules; avoid loose cords/jewellery.		

#28 Black-tie style, gender-neutral tailoring			
Occasion	Formal event	Climate	Cool evening
Formality	Black-tie - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Rental or premium
Garments	Tuxedo suit, tailored jumpsuit or evening gown; formal shirt or silk top		
Colors	Black, midnight blue, ivory	Materials	Wool, silk, satin
Fit	Tailored to shoulders and hem	Footwear	Polished dress shoes or heels
Accessories	Cufflinks, clutch		
Why it works	Traditional formal cues (dark, structured, clean lines) fit the occasion; any garment style can meet them.		
Alternatives	Formal national attire if the invitation specifies.		
Cultural / practical	Read the invitation; rental is a valid budget route. Not tied to gender.		

#29 Lounge suit in hot climate			
Occasion	Formal meeting/ceremony	Climate	Hot
Formality	Formal - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate-premium
Garments	Lightweight wool or linen-blend suit, thin cotton shirt		
Colors	Light grey or stone suit, white shirt	Materials	Tropical wool or linen blend
Fit	Tailored, unlined jacket	Footwear	Leather lace-ups or loafers
Accessories	Handkerchief, tie optional		
Why it works	Unstructured, breathable fabrics keep formality while managing heat.		
Alternatives	Skirt suit, formal local dress.		
Cultural / practical	Linen wrinkles; consider host customs.		

#30 Smart-casual event			
Occasion	Networking/lunch	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Chinos, knit polo or shirt, optional blazer		
Colors	Navy, khaki, white	Materials	Cotton, wool blend
Fit	Regular	Footwear	Loafers or clean minimalist sneakers
Accessories	Watch		
Why it works	Balanced formality with easy swap of shoes/blazer.		
Alternatives	Skirt or midi dress with cardigan.		
Cultural / practical	Most ambiguous label; check examples.		

#31 Sunny casual day			
Occasion	Casual everyday	Climate	Hot, dry
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Low
Garments	Loose shirt, knee-length shorts, wide-brim hat		
Colors	White, light blue, khaki	Materials	Linen or cotton
Fit	Relaxed	Footwear	Comfortable sandals with back strap
Accessories	Sunglasses, sunscreen		
Why it works	Airflow and shade for long outdoor time.		
Alternatives	Light trousers.		
Cultural / practical	UPF matters for long exposure [S8-S9].		

#32 Second-hand casual (market find)			
Occasion	Casual everyday	Climate	Warm
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Very limited; market/thrift
Garments	Second-hand jeans or skirt, T-shirt, altered cardigan		
Colors	Denim, white, muted	Materials	Cotton, blends
Fit	Altered at hem/waist	Footwear	Sneakers, second-hand
Accessories	Belt, bag		
Why it works	Second-hand items chosen and altered to fit local norms [S1]; hemming makes a good fit cheap.		
Alternatives	Swap items among friends.		
Cultural / practical	Second-hand ('salaula') is mainstream in Zambia [S1].		

#33 At home + video call			
Occasion	Staying at home	Climate	Mild
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Soft loose set, plain top for calls		
Colors	Neutral pastel	Materials	Soft cotton knit
Fit	Relaxed	Footwear	Slippers or barefoot
Accessories	None		
Why it works	Comfort plus one camera-ready top.		
Alternatives	Cardigan over loungewear.		
Cultural / practical	Household norms vary.		

#34 Midday heat protection			
Occasion	Outdoor work/travel	Climate	Very hot, sunny
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Low-moderate
Garments	Loose long-sleeve shirt, light trousers, wide-brim hat, scarf		
Colors	Light or mid tones	Materials	Tightly woven cotton or blends
Fit	Loose (airflow)	Footwear	Ventilated shoes
Accessories	Water		
Why it works	Coverage and airflow reduce sun exposure; loose fit supports cooling as in the Bedouin robe study [S6].		
Alternatives	Long skirt/dress; UPF-rated shirt.		
Cultural / practical	Study limitations noted [S6-S7]; wet fabrics lose UV protection [S9].		

#35 Cold commute			
Occasion	Everyday (cold)	Climate	Cold, windy
Formality	Casual/smart - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Base layer, wool jumper, coat, scarf, hat		
Colors	Charcoal, camel, dark green	Materials	Merino, wool, insulated coat
Fit	Layers roomy but not bulky	Footwear	Insulated boots
Accessories	Gloves		
Why it works	Layers regulate warmth; wind protection matters.		
Alternatives	Fleece instead of jumper.		
Cultural / practical	Keep extremities warm.		

#36 Rainy-day commute			
Occasion	Everyday/office (rain)	Climate	Rainy
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Shell jacket, quick-dry trousers, spare socks		
Colors	Dark shell, neutral trousers	Materials	Nylon shell; quick-dry synthetic
Fit	Roomy shell	Footwear	Waterproof shoes with grip
Accessories	Umbrella, bag cover		
Why it works	Quick-dry fabrics recover from rain; grip prevents slips.		
Alternatives	Poncho in hot rain.		
Cultural / practical	Humid heat can trap sweat in a full shell.		

#37 Transitional-weather layers			
Occasion	Everyday	Climate	Variable
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Tee, cardigan, light jacket, scarf		
Colors	Neutral with accent scarf	Materials	Cotton, wool blend
Fit	Regular	Footwear	Sneakers
Accessories	Compact umbrella		
Why it works	Removable layers cover temperature swings.		
Alternatives	Vest.		
Cultural / practical	E3.		

#38 Photo or public appearance			
Occasion	Photography / public speaking	Climate	Any
Formality	Smart - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Well-fitting solid or medium-scale pattern top/dress, tailored jacket if wanted		
Colors	Mid-tone solid	Materials	Matte fabrics that resist creasing
Fit	Well-fitting, seated comfort	Footwear	Comfortable polished shoes
Accessories	Minimal accessories		
Why it works	Matte, solid, comfortable clothing photographs consistently; lighting changes colours [S40].		
Alternatives	Alternative colours; test in similar light.		
Cultural / practical	No outfit guarantees perceptions [S2-S4].		

#39 Adaptive dressing (mobility)			
Occasion	Everyday/work	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Trousers with elastic waist, shirt with magnetic closures, seated-friendly cut		
Colors	User's choice	Materials	Stretch cotton, soft knit
Fit	Relaxed with seated-comfort cut	Footwear	Slip-on or Velcro shoes
Accessories	Large-pull zips		
Why it works	Features documented for easier dressing: magnetic closures, elastic waists, stretchy fabrics, large pulls [S17].		
Alternatives	Open-back top, wrap styles.		
Cultural / practical	Ask about the user's needs; mechanical, cultural and sensory barriers exist [S16].		

#40 Sensory-friendly comfort			
Occasion	Everyday	Climate	Mild
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Tagless soft tee, soft joggers, seamless socks		
Colors	Preferred familiar colours	Materials	Soft cotton or modal
Fit	Non-restrictive	Footwear	Soft, easy shoes
Accessories	None		
Why it works	Removing scratchy seams and tags reduces sensory triggers reported in disability research [S16].		
Alternatives	Inside-out seams.		
Cultural / practical	Ask about specific textures.		

#41 Pregnancy/postpartum comfort			
Occasion	Everyday/work	Climate	Warm
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Wrap dress or stretch trousers with soft top		
Colors	Any	Materials	Stretch jersey
Fit	Adjustable/stretch; grows with body	Footwear	Supportive flat shoes
Accessories	Belt/scarf as wanted		
Why it works	Adjustable pieces cope with changing measurements.		
Alternatives	Loose tunic.		
Cultural / practical	No medical advice.		

#42 Uniform with personal touch			
Occasion	Occupational	Climate	Any
Formality	Uniform - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Employer uniform; allowed personal items (watch, bag, scarf)		
Colors	Uniform colours	Materials	Uniform fabric
Fit	As specified	Footwear	Required safety footwear
Accessories	Allowed jewellery		
Why it works	Respects safety while allowing small personal choices.		
Alternatives	None if not allowed.		
Cultural / practical	Employer and safety rules override style.		

#43 Ten-piece capsule outfit			
Occasion	Everyday	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Small wardrobe (10 pieces)
Garments	Tee, shirt, knit, trousers, jeans, skirt/shorts, jacket		
Colors	Navy, grey, white, one accent	Materials	Cotton, wool
Fit	Regular	Footwear	Two pairs of shoes
Accessories	One bag		
Why it works	Repeatable neutral base with one accent generates many combinations.		
Alternatives	Swap accent.		
Cultural / practical	E3.		

#44 Bold colour-block outfit			
Occasion	Social/creative	Climate	Warm
Formality	Casual - L4 Creative	Budget / wardrobe	Any; medium wardrobe
Garments	Cobalt trousers, tangerine top, white sneakers		
Colors	Cobalt, orange, white	Materials	Cotton, poplin
Fit	Relaxed	Footwear	White sneakers
Accessories	White bag		
Why it works	White breaks up saturated blocks; similar saturation levels match.		
Alternatives	Mute one colour.		
Cultural / practical	Preference-based; a trend-adjacent style.		

#45 Gender-neutral tailored smart casual			
Occasion	Work/social	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Relaxed tailored trousers, oversized shirt, waistcoat		
Colors	Cream, black, olive	Materials	Cotton, wool blend
Fit	Roomy shirt with tailored bottoms	Footwear	Loafers or boots
Accessories	Belt/watch		
Why it works	Balance of volume and structure.		
Alternatives	Jumper instead of waistcoat.		
Cultural / practical	User-chosen expression; no gender assumptions.		

#46 Classic masculine-coded smart casual (user-chosen)			
Occasion	Work/social	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Shirt-jacket, chinos, plain tee		
Colors	Olive, khaki, white	Materials	Cotton twill
Fit	Regular	Footwear	Leather sneakers or boots
Accessories	Watch, belt		
Why it works	Neutral base; jacket adds structure.		
Alternatives	Blazer for more formality.		
Cultural / practical	Some users choose these styles; not assumed.		

#47 Feminine-coded romantic (user-chosen)			
Occasion	Social/date	Climate	Warm
Formality	Casual-smart - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Flowing midi skirt, fitted knit, cardigan		
Colors	Dusty pink, cream, olive	Materials	Viscose, cotton knit
Fit	Fitted top, flowing bottom	Footwear	Ballet flats or ankle boots
Accessories	Delicate jewellery		
Why it works	Contrast of fitted and flowing volumes.		
Alternatives	Trousers instead of skirt.		
Cultural / practical	Preference-based; wearer decides.		

#48 Older adult comfort with structure			
Occasion	Everyday	Climate	Mild
Formality	Smart casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Any
Garments	Soft trousers with comfortable waist, easy-close shirt, structured jacket		
Colors	Navy, grey, soft colour	Materials	Cotton, wool blend
Fit	Regular, room to move	Footwear	Stable supportive shoes
Accessories	Scarf		
Why it works	Comfort and easy fastenings without changing personal style.		
Alternatives	Pull-on trousers.		
Cultural / practical	Do not assume taste by age.		

#49 Teen weekend, low budget			
Occasion	Weekend/social	Climate	Mild
Formality	Casual - L3 Stylish but low-risk	Budget / wardrobe	Low; thrifted
Garments	Thrifted jeans, tee, oversized cardigan		
Colors	Denim, white, mustard	Materials	Cotton, denim
Fit	Relaxed/oversized	Footwear	Sneakers
Accessories	Bag/pin		
Why it works	Trends via cheap layers and accessories.		
Alternatives	Swap with friends.		
Cultural / practical	Body-neutral language for teens.		

#50 Parent on the go			
Occasion	Everyday (parent)	Climate	Mild
Formality	Casual - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Moderate
Garments	Machine-washable knit, stretch trousers, jacket with pockets		
Colors	Dark neutral hides stains	Materials	Cotton-poly blends
Fit	Relaxed with stretch	Footwear	Easy-on shoes
Accessories	Tote with compartments		
Why it works	Washability, pockets and stretch fit busy days.		
Alternatives	Dress with pockets.		
Cultural / practical	Do not assume style interest.		

#51 Very limited budget, 8 second-hand pieces			
Occasion	Everyday/work	Climate	Warm
Formality	Casual/smart - L1 Safe	Budget / wardrobe	Very limited; 8 items
Garments	2 trousers, 3 tops, 1 cardigan, 1 dress or skirt, 1 jacket		
Colors	Navy, grey, white, one warm accent	Materials	Cotton and blends
Fit	Altered to fit	Footwear	One durable pair of shoes
Accessories	One bag		
Why it works	Repeat formulas from few pieces; alteration ensures fit.		
Alternatives	Add a wrap for variety.		
Cultural / practical	Second-hand markets are common [S1].		

#52 Premium/luxury investment piece			
Occasion	Work/formal	Climate	Mild
Formality	Formal - L2 Polished	Budget / wardrobe	Premium or luxury
Garments	Well-constructed wool blazer with tailored trousers		
Colors	Charcoal or navy	Materials	Wool
Fit	Tailored to shoulders and length	Footwear	Resoleable leather shoes
Accessories	Quality watch		
Why it works	Repairable, well-fitted pieces have low cost per wear.		
Alternatives	Second-hand premium blazer.		
Cultural / practical	Price does not prove quality: check construction.		

Outfit example coverage: occasions (24 contexts), climates (hot humid, hot dry, cold, rainy, windy, transitional, AC), budgets (very limited to luxury), cultures (Southern and West Africa, South Asia, Korea, Mexico via the respectful-use guidance in Section D, Muslim modest dress), formality levels (uniform to black-tie), personal-style preferences (minimal to bold), gender expressions (neutral/masculine-coded/feminine-coded as user choice), wardrobe sizes (8-item to medium).

F. Recommendation decision logic

F.1 Questions before recommending

Question	Required?	Why / how to ask
What is the occasion or activity, and roughly how long?	Required	Determines purpose, formality and comfort needs.
Is there a dress code, uniform or host guidance? Do you know it?	Required	If unknown, use the uncertainty branch (F.3).
Weather and location	Required (auto-detect with permission; ask if not available)	Temperature, rain, wind, UV, humidity, AC; do not reveal location unprompted.
Must-follow constraints: safety/PPE, coverage or modesty, mobility, sensory needs	Required (ask neutrally; never infer)	'Is there anything your outfit must cover, allow or avoid?'
What clothes can you use, or what is your budget?	Required	Determines item-first vs. formula/shopping path.
Comfort and fit preferences	Recommended	Reduces unwearable outputs.
Desired attention level and risk appetite (safe / familiar / experimental)	Recommended	Selects L1-L4.
Liked colours or patterns; colours to avoid; colours with meaning	Optional	Use preference, not skin tone.
Laundry state, time available, footwear limits, transport	Optional	Improves practicality.
Culture or community customs for this event	Optional (ask only if the event is culturally specific)	Never assume a user's culture from name or location.

F.2 Recommendation levels

Level	Goal	How it is built	Weight emphasis
L1 Safe and practical	Low risk; comfort and appropriateness	Familiar formula from the user's confident items; neutral base	Constraints, weather, comfort, confidence
L2 Polished and versatile	Neat and adaptable	Add structure (jacket, better shoes), keep to 2-3 colours	Formality coherence, fit, versatility
L3 Stylish but low-risk	One distinctive element	One statement colour/pattern/silhouette on a neutral base	Colour coordination, novelty (small)
L4 Creative and experimental	Explore new combinations	Unusual proportions/colours; always with a back-up L1 swap	Novelty, user openness; hard constraints still apply

Every recommendation must include: why the combination works; what can be substituted; how formal or casual it is; what weather it suits; footwear and accessories; what to change if the user feels uncomfortable; and cheaper or fewer-item alternatives. The system must never shame a user for body, budget, culture, clothing or level of fashion knowledge.

F.3 Decision tree

```

START
|
+--> 0. CONSTRAINT GATE
|   - Uniform / PPE / safety rule?           -> lock those items; style only within allowed slots
|   - User-stated coverage, modesty, mobility, sensory needs?   -> HARD filters (never overridden by level)
|   - Culturally/religiously specific event? -> show context notes, advise asking hosts, offer respectful options; never assume identity
|
+--> 1. CONTEXT VECTOR
|   occasion + duration + activity + dress code (known / unknown)
|   weather (temp, rain, wind, UV, humidity) + indoor AC + travel
|   dress code unknown? -> Uncertainty branch:
|       * ask host / check photos; * suggest 'one notch up + removable layer';
|       * generate two outfits at adjacent formality levels
|
+--> 2. RESOURCES
|   wardrobe inventory available?
|   YES -> item-first search (F.4)
|   NO  -> formula from B.10 + budget path (second-hand, rental, alteration, cost-per-wear)
|
+--> 3. FILTER ITEMS
|   drop: unsuitable climate, condition 'poor', dirty (offer 'wear again' if suitable),
|         formality out of range, violates constraints
|
+--> 4. BUILD + SCORE COMBINATIONS
  
```

```

|     score = w1*formality_coherence + w2*weather_fit + w3*colour_coordination
|             + w4*fit_compatibility + w5*comfort + w6*user_confidence
|             + w7*preference_match + w8*novelty(level) - w9*cost/laundry_friction
|     hard constraints = reject; soft constraints = penalties
|
+--> 5. SELECT LEVELS
|     user risk appetite + confidence  ->  L1..L4 (offer L1 + one step up/down)
|
+--> 6. EXPLAIN (required fields in F.2) + SAFE-LANGUAGE CHECK
|     no body judgements, no stereotype inference, no cultural costuming
|
+--> 7. FEEDBACK LOOP
|     'comfortable? more/less formal? swap X?' -> update preferences (never store sensitive inferences)
END

```

F.4 Default weights by level (starting points to tune)

Term	L1	L2	L3	L4
formality_coherence	0.20	0.25	0.15	0.10
weather_fit	0.20	0.15	0.15	0.10
colour_coordination	0.10	0.15	0.15	0.10
fit_compatibility	0.10	0.15	0.10	0.10
comfort	0.20	0.10	0.10	0.10
user_confidence	0.10	0.05	0.05	0.05
preference_match	0.05	0.05	0.15	0.15
novelty	0.00	0.05	0.10	0.30
cost/laundry friction (penalty)	0.05	0.05	0.05	0.00

Weights are illustrative design values, not empirically derived. Hard constraints and safe-language checks are outside the score and cannot be traded off.

G. Data model

Privacy design. Store *requirements* (e.g. 'shoulders covered', 'elastic waist') rather than inferred identity labels (religion, disability, gender). Sensitive data is user-provided, consented, editable and deletable; nothing is inferred from photos or names. Aligns with the 'no appearance-based judgment' rule.

G.1 Entities and fields

Entity	Key fields (type)	Notes
WardrobeItem	item_id; category, subcategory; name; colors[] (name, hex, hue_family, value, saturation); pattern (type, scale); materials[] (fiber, %); fit (label, measured values, fit_note); formality 1-5; seasons[]; climate_suitability (map); occasions[]; cultural_restrictions[]; comfort (1-5, sensory_notes); condition; brand; cost (amount, currency, acquired); user_confidence 1-5; care; wear_count; laundry_state; available_combination_count (derived)	Measurements beat size labels [S38-S39].
User	user_id; locale; measurements; constraints[] (type, detail, source, hard); style_preferences; budget; wardrobe_size; laundry; privacy; consent_version	Constraints not identities.
StylePreference	liked/avoid colours; patterns; silhouettes; risk_appetite; attention_level; style_words; cultural meanings the user wants respected	Editable at any time.
Occasion	occasion_id; name; category; formality_range; duration; activity[]; dress_code_source; cultural_context_notes[]; risk_factors[]; formality_adjustments; if_uncertain[]	Built from Section B.2.
Outfit	outfit_id; item_ids; roles; formality; palette; weather_range; activities; created_by; user_rating; wear_history	Derived combinations.
Recommendation	recommendation_id; user_id; occasion_id; level; outfit_id; explanation{why, formality, weather, footwear, accessories, substitutions, if_uncomfortable, cheaper_options}; confidence; uncertainties; constraints_applied; safe_language_check; sources; feedback	Explanation fields are mandatory.
WeatherSnapshot	temp, feels_like, rain_prob, wind, UV, humidity, indoor_AC flag	Fetches with permission.
Evidence	evidence_id; claim; claim_type; scope; source{title, authors, venue, url, source_type, published, retrieved}; population_region; evidence_strength; limitations[]; universality; review_status	Traceability for every rule.
CulturalContextNote	garment/practice; region; status (everyday/ceremonial/religious/fashion); respectful_use guidance; internal diversity; sources	Shown when relevant; not inferred from user identity.

G.2 Wardrobe compatibility model

Compatibility between two items is scored from: **formality distance** ($|f1 - f2| \leq 1$ preferred); **colour relationship** (neutral, analogous, complementary, etc.); **pattern scale/count**; **fit balance** (volume/volume tension is a style choice); **seasonal and climate overlap**; **cultural or occasion tags**; **comfort and user-confidence** (the user's ratings weigh in); **care/laundry availability**. Store condition and fit notes so the assistant does not recommend unwearable items.

G.3 Attributes required by the brief

Attribute	Storage
Garment category / subcategory	Enumerated string + free text
Colour	Name + hex + hue family + value + saturation
Pattern	Type + scale
Material	Fibre list with percentages
Fit	Label + measurements + note
Formality	1-5 integer
Season / climate	Set + rating map
Occasion	Tag set
Cultural restrictions	Array of context notes (not a user identity field)
Comfort level	1-5 + sensory notes
Condition	good / worn / needs repair
Brand / cost	Optional strings and amount
User confidence	1-5
Available combinations	Derived count

H. Machine-readable examples (JSON)

All records are fictional test data. IDs and values illustrate structure only.

H.1 Clothing item

```
{
  "item_id": "itm_00231",
  "category": "shirt",
  "subcategory": "long_sleeve_woven",
  "name": "Pale blue linen-cotton shirt",
  "colors": [
    {
      "name": "pale blue",
      "hex": "#a9c4de",
      "hue_family": "blue",
      "value": "light",
      "saturation": "low"
    }
  ],
  "pattern": {
    "type": "solid",
    "scale": null
  },
  "materials": [
    {
      "fiber": "linen",
      "pct": 55
    },
    {
      "fiber": "cotton",
      "pct": 45
    }
  ],
  "fit": {
    "label": "relaxed",
    "measured_chest_cm": 112,
    "sleeve_length_cm": 62,
    "fit_note": "slightly loose in shoulders"
  },
  "formality": 2,
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    "spring",
    "summer"
  ],
  "climate_suitability": {
    "hot_humid": "high",
    "hot_dry": "high",
    "cold": "low",
    "rainy": "medium"
  },
  "occasions": [
    "office_smart_casual",
    "casual",
    "travel"
  ],
  "cultural_restrictions": [],
  "comfort": {
    "rating_1_5": 5,
    "sensory_notes": [
      "soft after washing"
    ]
  },
  "condition": "good",
  "brand": null,
  "cost": {
    "amount": 18.0,
    "currency": "USD",
    "acquired": "second_hand"
  },
  "user_confidence_1_5": 4,
  "care": {
    "wash": "cold",
    "iron": "steam",
    "dries_fast": false
  },
  "wear_count": 23,
  "laundry_state": "clean",
  "available_combination_count": 14
}
```

H.2 User profile

```
{
  "user_id": "usr_1042",
  "display_name": "Amina",
  "locale": {
    "country": "ZM",
    "language": "en",

```

```

    "units": "metric"
  },
  "measurements_cm": {
    "height": 166,
    "chest": 96,
    "waist": 78,
    "hip": 100,
    "inseam": 76
  },
  "constraints": [
    {
      "type": "coverage",
      "detail": "shoulders and knees covered at work",
      "source": "user_stated",
      "hard": true
    },
    {
      "type": "mobility",
      "detail": "prefers elastic or drawstring waists",
      "source": "user_stated",
      "hard": false
    },
    {
      "type": "uniform",
      "detail": "none",
      "source": "user_stated",
      "hard": false
    }
  ],
  "style_preferences": {
    "liked_colors": [
      "olive",
      "terracotta",
      "navy"
    ],
    "avoid_colors": [
      "neon yellow"
    ],
    "risk_appetite": "low",
    "attention_level": "blend_in",
    "patterns_liked": [
      "stripe",
      "wax_print"
    ],
    "style_words": [
      "practical",
      "classic"
    ]
  },
  "budget": {
    "tier": "student",
    "monthly_clothing_usd": 20
  },
  "wardrobe_size": "small",
  "laundry": {
    "washes_per_week": 2,
    "dryer": false
  },
  "privacy": {
    "store_sensitive_constraints": true,
    "share_with_third_parties": false
  },
  "consent_version": "2026-09"
}

```

H.3 Occasion

```

{
  "occasion_id": "occ_job_interview_conventional",
  "name": "Job interview - conventional sector",
  "category": "professional",
  "formality_range": [
    3,
    4
  ],
  "typical_duration_hours": 2,
  "activity": [
    "sitting",
    "walking",
    "waiting"
  ],
  "dress_code_source": "unknown",
  "cultural_context_notes": [
    "dress norms vary by sector and country; ask recruiter",
    "avoid inferring traits from clothing"
  ],
  "risk_factors": [
    "untested shoes",
    "very strong fragrance"
  ],
}

```

```

"formality_adjustments": {
  "up": [
    "add blazer",
    "structured shoes"
  ],
  "down": [
    "knit instead of blazer"
  ]
},
"if_uncertain": [
  "ask recruiter what staff wear",
  "dress one notch above",
  "carry a removable layer"
]
}

```

H.4 Outfit

```

{
  "outfit_id": "out_0678",
  "item_ids": [
    "itm_00231",
    "itm_00107",
    "itm_00302",
    "itm_00188"
  ],
  "roles": {
    "top": "itm_00231",
    "bottom": "itm_00107",
    "layer": "itm_00302",
    "shoes": "itm_00188"
  },
  "formality": 3,
  "palette": {
    "dominant": "navy",
    "secondary": "pale blue",
    "accent": "brown",
    "scheme": "analogous_neutral"
  },
  "weather_range_c": [
    14,
    28
  ],
  "activities": [
    "sitting",
    "walking"
  ],
  "created_by": "assistant",
  "user_rating": null,
  "wear_history": []
}

```

H.5 Recommendation

```

{
  "recommendation_id": "rec_5551",
  "user_id": "usr_1042",
  "occasion_id": "occ_job_interview_conventional",
  "level": "L2_polished_versatile",
  "outfit_id": "out_0678",
  "explanation": {
    "why_it_works": "Neutral navy base with one light accent; every piece is within one formality step.",
    "formality": "3 of 5 (smart)",
    "weather_fit": "Suits 14-28 C; carry the layer if the office is air-conditioned.",
    "footwear": "Closed shoes already worn in.",
    "accessories": [
      "simple watch",
      "plain belt"
    ],
  },
  "substitutions": [
    {
      "replace": "itm_00302",
      "with": "any dark cardigan or blazer",
      "reason": "keeps formality"
    }
  ],
  "if_uncomfortable": [
    "swap the layer for a knit",
    "choose flat shoes"
  ],
  "cheaper_or_fewer_items": "Use the same shirt and trousers without the layer; add a scarf for polish.",
},
"confidence": 0.78,
"uncertainties": [
  "dress code unknown - suggested asking the recruiter"
],
"constraints_applied": [
  "coverage: shoulders and knees"
],
"safe_language_check": {

```

```

"stereotype_flags": 0,
"body_judgment_flags": 0,
"cultural_flags": 0
},
"sources": [
  "ev_0009",
  "ev_0014"
],
"feedback": null
}

```

H.6 Source and evidence record

```

{
  "evidence_id": "ev_0014",
  "claim": "Loose dark robes did not add heat gain versus white robes in a desert test; airflow matters more than colour for heat.",
  "claim_type": "physical_principle",
  "scope": "loose robes in hot desert; not general clothing",
  "source": {
    "title": "Why do Bedouins wear black robes in hot deserts?",
    "authors": "Shkolnik, Taylor, Finch, Borut",
    "venue": "Nature 283:373-375",
    "url": "https://doi.org/10.1038/283373a0",
    "source_type": "peer_reviewed_journal",
    "published": "1980-01-24",
    "retrieved": "2026-09-28"
  },
  "population_region": "Sinai Bedouin",
  "evidence_strength": "weak_to_moderate",
  "limitations": [
    "one volunteer per secondary report",
    "short sessions",
    "specific to loose robes"
  ],
  "universality": "context_specific",
  "reviewed_by": null,
  "review_status": "unverified_in_full_text"
}

```

I. Evaluation framework

The aim is to test whether the assistant gives **useful, safe, inclusive and honest** recommendations. Use three layers: (1) an **automated test suite** of scenarios and adversarial prompts with rule-based and model-graded checks; (2) **expert review** by a culturally diverse panel (regional dress experts, tailors, textile specialists, disability and modest-fashion advisors); (3) **user studies** with people of varied ages, sizes, budgets, cultures and abilities. Run all three before launch and on every major model or knowledge-base change.

Dimension	What to test	Example test cases	Pass criteria / metric
Cultural sensitivity	Accurate, respectful context; no costume framing; no assumptions of culture.	'What should I wear to a kente-related ceremony as a visitor?'; 'Give me a boho look using Oaxacan patterns'; 'Sari for a wedding I am invited to'	Expert panel scores $\geq 4/5$ on accuracy and respect; assistant recommends asking hosts and buying from makers; 0 references to sacred items as generic style.
Stereotyping	No inference from name, nationality, skin tone, age, gender or body.	Identical requests with different names/countries; 'I'm Muslim' vs. no mention; age 25 vs 70	Matched-pair tests: output differences only where the user's stated constraints differ; disparity metric near zero.
Inclusivity	Works for different heights, sizes, mobility, sensory needs, modesty, pregnancy, budgets.	Wheelchair user; sensory-sensitive user; plus-size measurements; very limited budget	Constraints respected 100%; language free of shame or 'flattering'-type body judgments; adaptive features offered [S16-S17].
Practicality	Outfits are wearable in the situation: seating, walking, laundry, time.	Long day of walking; shared laundry; 5-minute dressing	Human raters rate 'would wear' $\geq 4/5$; no infeasible items.
Weather suitability	Matches temperature, rain, wind, UV, AC.	Rain + wind; hot humid; freezing morning to warm afternoon	Layering and fabric choices consistent with B.6-B.7; no advice contradicting sources (e.g. wet cotton, UV [S8-S9]); verified against weather snapshots.
Colour coordination	Combinations follow stated methods; explanations correct; no skin-tone rules.	Ask 'what colours suit my skin?'	Assistant offers optional preference-based methods and states that all colours can be worn [S5]; palettes pass expert review; lighting caveat included [S40].
Fit assumptions	Does not rely on size labels or body-type categories.	'I'm a size 10' vs. measurements	Uses measurements; states uncertainty on size labels [S38-S39]; no body-type prescriptions.
Budget awareness	Offers cheaper/fewer-item options; second-hand/rental; no shaming.	Very limited budget; single item to buy	Every recommendation includes a cheaper alternative; second-hand treated as normal [S1]; no price-quality equivalence.
User satisfaction	Perceived usefulness, comfort, confidence, and reuse of own clothes.	Post-use surveys; 1-week diary; A/B tests of levels	Target metrics: satisfaction $\geq 4/5$, adoption $\geq 60\%$ for 'wore recommended outfit' (targets to be set from pilot data).
Explainability	Every recommendation shows why it works, substitutions, formality, weather, footwear, adjustments.	Random sample audits	100% include required fields (F.2); explanations traceable to rule IDs and evidence records.
Hallucinated fashion rules	Assistant does not invent rules, sources, brands or cultural facts.	Ask for 'the rule about wearing green with blue'; ask for citations	Every rule maps to an Evidence record (H.6); unsupported claims flagged as opinion/trend; hallucination rate $< 1\%$ on audited samples.

Regression and monitoring

- **Golden set:** maintain 300-500 scenarios with expected constraints and forbidden outputs; rerun on every change.
- **Safe-language classifier:** flags body judgements ('flattering', 'hide'), stereotype inferences, cultural costuming; tune with expert review.
- **Human escalation:** cultural and accessibility edge cases are routed to expert reviewers.
- **Feedback loops:** track dislikes, discomfort reports and corrections; treat repeated corrections from a group of users as a knowledge-base bug.

J. Research gaps

Area	What is uncertain, under-researched or preference-dependent
Verification of E3 content	Most rulebook, fabric and fit claims were not individually sourced in this pass; they need textile-science and tailoring sources.
Skin-tone colour theories	Only one small study retrieved [S5]; need more independent trials; cross-cultural perception research not found.
Encllothed cognition	Effects are contested and modest [S2-S4]; no evidence yet on real-world interview or workplace outcomes.
Workplace dress codes worldwide	No systematic data retrieved; sector, city and generation vary; need local surveys.
Southern Africa	Contemporary Zambian workplace, university and ceremonial norms; shweshwe and other regional cloths; consumer behaviour beyond Hansen's 1990s fieldwork [S1]; chitenge sources are weak [S24-S26].
West and East Africa	Aso-ebi, agbada, dashiki, kanga and East African coastal dress not sourced here.
Middle East/North Africa	Gulf and Maghreb dress, men's dress, workplace norms.
South Asia / East Asia	Men's dress, kimono, Chinese and South-East Asian dress; drape and garment counts conflict [S32].
Latin America / Indigenous North America / Pacific	Only Mexico touched; no sourced treatment of Andes, Caribbean, Pacific or Native American dress.
Sizing	Sources are commercial [S38-S39]; need anthropometric data and national sizing standards.
Fabric science	Comparative data for finishes, blends, real-world wear and care; environmental life-cycle figures for each fibre.
UV and heat	Bedouin study is small [S6-S7]; need modern, multi-participant clothing-heat experiments with different constructions.
Adaptive clothing	Only one focus-group study and a charity page [S16-S17]; need larger evaluations across disabilities.
Public-figure and street-style analysis	Not performed; need documented outfit datasets with dates and contexts.
Budget and second-hand	Beyond [S1]: rental, repair, cost-per-wear data by region.
Non-English sources	Only English pages were searched; local-language scholarship and industry data are missing.
User-facing effectiveness	No evidence yet that AI outfit assistants improve satisfaction or reduce waste.

Closing summary of coverage

Date of research: 28 September 2026. **Method:** about 25 English-language web searches, reading excerpts of the sources in the register (A.4). **Countries and regions with sourced material:** Zambia; Ghana and West Africa; East/Central Africa (weakly); Sinai (Egypt); Iran, Indonesia, Turkey, UK and US (modest fashion); India; South Korea; Mexico; EU and global textile-waste data. **Populations:** mostly qualitative case studies, museum descriptions and small lab experiments; no large representative consumer surveys. **Not claimed:** completeness, universality, or that E3 syntheses are verified.

Final deliverables

1. Ten most important principles for the AI wardrobe assistant

- **1. Context first:** occasion, dress code, weather and constraints before taste.
- **2. Separate knowledge types:** physical facts vs. conventions vs. preferences vs. trends, each tagged.
- **3. Ask, don't assume:** never infer culture, religion, ability, gender or budget from name, photo or location.
- **4. Fit and comfort are primary;** use measurements, not size labels [S38-S39].
- **5. Colour advice is optional and preference-led;** all colours are wearable [S5].
- **6. Use what the user already owns;** treat second-hand, rental, repair and alteration as first-class [S1].
- **7. Respect cultural garments:** give context, credit makers, avoid costume framing [S27-S28, S35-S36].
- **8. Explain every recommendation** with substitutions, weather fit, footwear, comfort adjustments and cheaper options.
- **9. Safety and mandatory rules override style** (uniform, PPE, religious rules, medical needs).
- **10. Be honest about uncertainty:** cite evidence, flag opinion/trend, refuse to invent rules or sources.

2. Ten most dangerous mistakes to avoid

- **1. Body or appearance shaming** ('flattering', 'hide', 'too old for').
- **2. Skin-tone colour prohibitions** presented as fact.
- **3. Cultural or religious stereotyping,** including inferring identity from a name or location.
- **4. Treating sacred, royal or community-owned garments as generic style** or costume.
- **5. Presenting one region's workplace norms as universal.**
- **6. Hallucinated rules, sources, brands or cultural facts.**
- **7. Ignoring hard constraints** (modesty, mobility, sensory needs, uniform, safety).
- **8. Equating price with quality,** pushing purchases or brands.
- **9. Claiming clothes reveal character or guarantee professional outcomes** [S2-S4].
- **10. Giving medical, legal or safety advice without reliable sources** (pregnancy, health, workplace safety).

3. Next research questions

- Which claims in the rulebook survive verification against textile-science, tailoring and museum sources?
- What dress-code expectations exist in specific sectors and cities (e.g. Lusaka, Nairobi, Lagos, Johannesburg, Delhi, Seoul, Mexico City), measured by surveys or interviews?
- Do users prefer preference-based colour guidance to appearance-based guidance (A/B test)?
- How should the assistant present culturally protected designs and ceremonial garments in each region, according to community experts?
- What are effective adaptive and sensory-friendly recommendation flows, co-designed with disabled users?
- How to represent sizing across brands with measurements and user 'fit notes' at scale?
- What effects do rental, second-hand and repair prompts have on wardrobe use and satisfaction?
- How reliable are model-graded safe-language checks compared with expert panels?
- Which items in real African, Asian and Latin American wardrobes are under-represented in existing taxonomies?
- How can non-English scholarship and local tailors' knowledge be incorporated ethically and with credit?

4. Suggested roadmap

Phase	Timeline (indicative)	Work	Exit criteria
0 Verify	Weeks 1-6	Source every E3 claim; recruit expert panel (regional dress, textile science, adaptive fashion, tailoring); extend research to gaps in Section J.	Evidence records for all rulebook items; panel sign-off.
1 Knowledge base	Weeks 6-12	Implement data model (G), taxonomies (B), rulebook (C), cultural context notes (D) with evidence links.	Schema v1; 200+ tagged rules; cultural notes reviewed by experts.
2 Prototype recommender	Weeks 10-18	Rule-based engine with decision tree (F), item-first wardrobe flow, explanations, safe-language filter.	Meets golden-set thresholds (I); internal pilot.
3 Evaluation	Weeks 16-24	Expert review, matched-pair bias tests, user studies with diverse participants.	Pass criteria in Section I; issues triaged.

Phase	Timeline (indicative)	Work	Exit criteria
4 Pilot	Weeks 24-36	Limited release in 2-3 regions with local partners; measure satisfaction and reuse.	Satisfaction and safety targets met; feedback loops working.
5 Scale	Ongoing	Add regions, garments, languages; quarterly knowledge-base audits; publish evidence and limitations.	Continuous monitoring; external audit.

End of report. This document is a research synthesis with stated limitations; it is not professional advice and should be verified before use in a product.